

VISUAL PLANNING SYSTEMS™

The Career Compass

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The Career Compass
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Printed on recycled paper. This binder is recyclable. 

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Introduction

Most of us spend at least one-third of our day at work. Many of us will have multiple jobs and more than one career. From time to time as circumstances in our lives change, it's beneficial to survey our career and determine if changes need to be made. In some instances, a job or career change will be our choice; at other times the change will be outside of our control. Regardless of the circumstances, being prepared for moving on to our next career phase can make the transition less stressful and more rewarding.

The Career Compass is a Visual Planning System™ that will help you creatively organize and manage your career options. The templates in this system take you through a step-by-step process that includes assessing your past and present, researching future possibilities, imagining yourself in different careers, and finally creating job search and networking plans to fulfill your self-defined goals.

How to Use These Materials

A career counselor or career coach can help you progress through each of the steps and provide additional insight and resources. A career counselor will also help you stay on task and keep the process going until you have completed the final stage and are on your way to making a change. A good resource for finding a counselor is the National Career Development Association (www.ncda.org).

If you would like to complete the process on your own, additional books and websites are provided throughout *The Career Compass* and in the Appendix to help you. We also recommend that you talk with family and/or friends to provide support as you move through the stages.

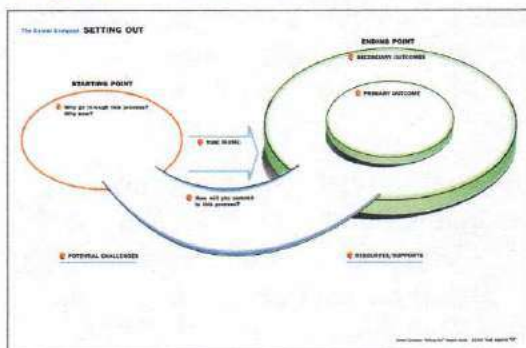
There is no wrong way of working with these templates. The content you provide from your own experience and research will create maps for successfully navigating your career change. Often, the immediate need for a new job will dictate how much time you can give to the entire process. If time permits, it is advantageous to allow time for reflection after each stages. Some templates will also require you to repeat them until you are satisfied with the outcome and ready to move onto the next stage. For this reason, there are extra copies of certain templates provided in the Appendix. To make it easy for you, we recommend that you take the templates out of the binder and work on them as you follow the instructions.

You may want to add additional research, job leads, and job offers to this binder—as well as your resume, cover letters, thank-you notes, and any other specific information to stay organized. Once you have a new job or career direction, be sure to keep your binder for reference at a later date or when it is time to reassess and perhaps make another change.

Career Compass Process Overview

Orient To Career Planning

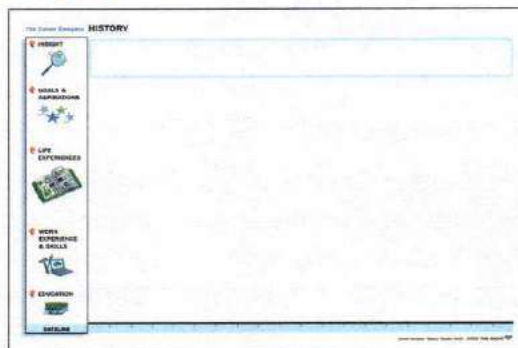
Stage 1: SETTING OUT



Clarify your reasons for career exploration—where you are now and where you want to be.

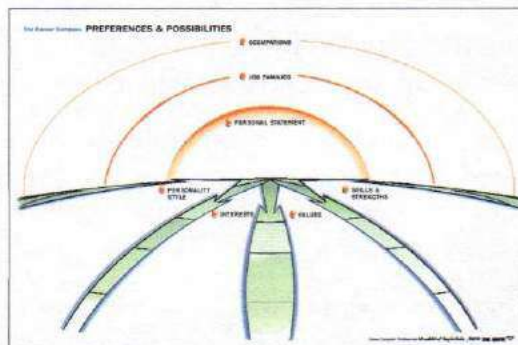
Assess Who You Are & What You Want

Stage 2: HISTORY



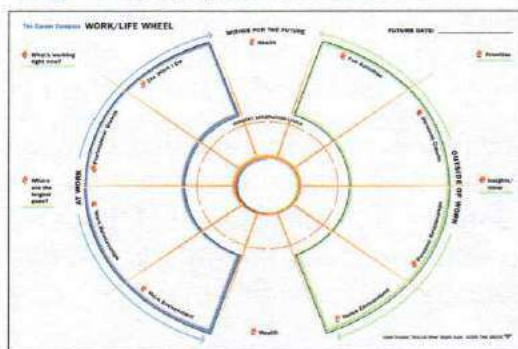
Learn from the past in order to make informed decisions about your future.

Stage 3: PREFERENCES & POSSIBILITIES



Clarify who you are, and learn about the occupations that might fit you.

Stage 4: WORK/LIFE WHEEL

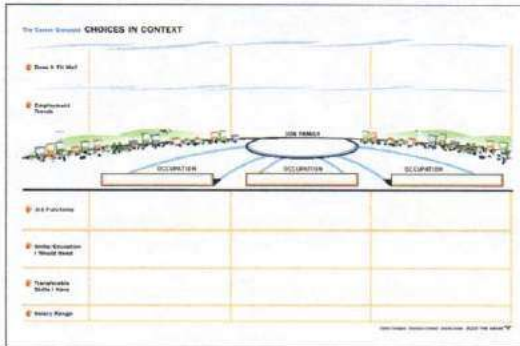


Imagine your preferred future, both at work and outside of work, in order to set priorities.

Research Your Options

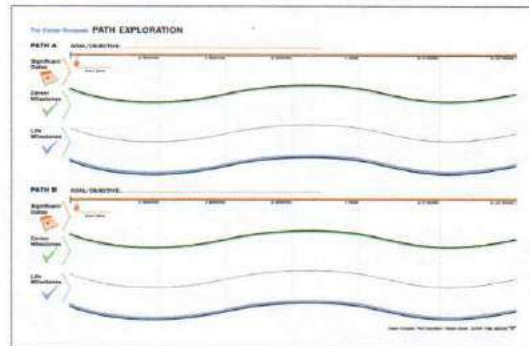
Focus Your Job Search

Stage 5: CHOICES IN CONTEXT



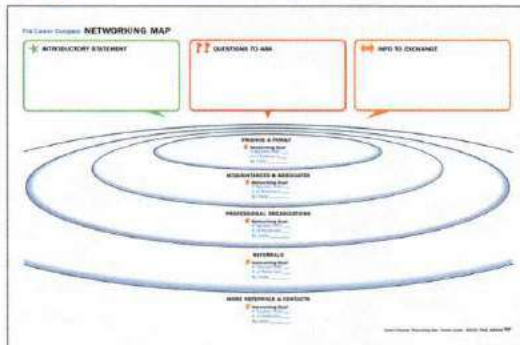
Begin researching occupations through secondary research: websites and publications.

Stage 8: PATH EXPLORATION



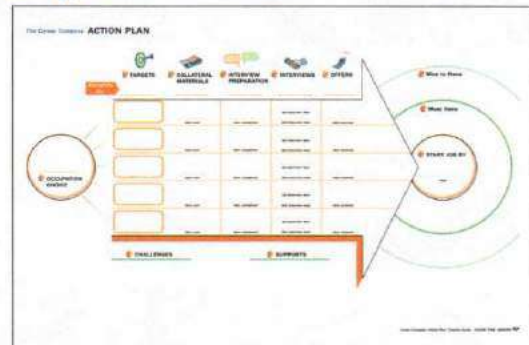
Decide on and craft the career path you want, while keeping a backup plan as an option.

Stage 6: NETWORKING MAP



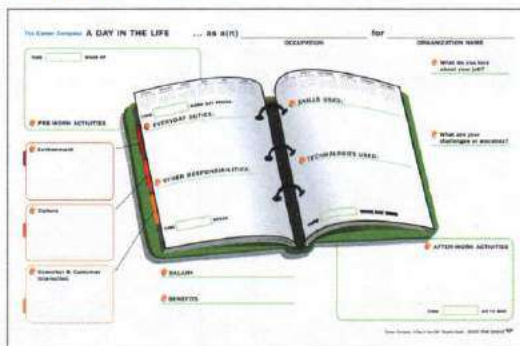
Start contacting others to learn firsthand about occupations and to create connections.

Stage 9: ACTION PLAN



Lay out the steps of your job search, and stay motivated to land the job you want.

Stage 7: A DAY IN THE LIFE



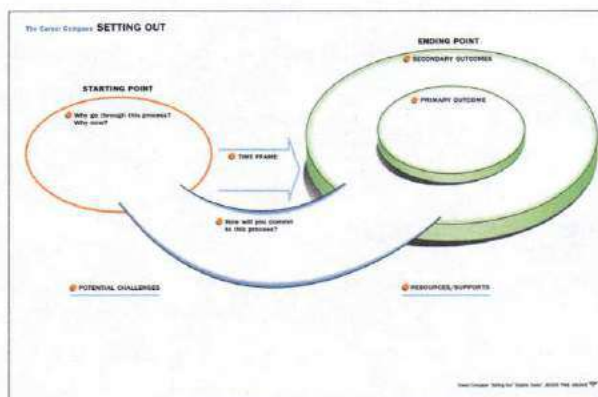
Continue your primary research—talking with others—to imagine yourself in an occupation.

Stage 1

SETTING OUT

Welcome to *The Career Compass*. You are beginning a thought-provoking, comprehensive process that will help you make informed career decisions. Whether you are just starting out in the work force, are in the middle of your career but seeking something new, or are nearing retirement and need to make a transition out of full-time work, *The Career Compass* will help you visualize and make change. The following instructions and templates provide frameworks for organizing your thoughts and research and developing your plans.

In this first stage, *Setting Out*, you will record your expectations for a career-change process. It is important for you (as well as your career counselor) to understand your motivation for embarking on this process. *Setting Out* provides a quick view of your current context and maps the beginnings of a future direction.



You'll always miss 100 percent of the shots you don't take.

Wayne Gretzky

SETTING OUT

Clarify Your Current Situation

Take a moment to explain where you stand currently and where you want to be when you have completed *The Career Compass* process. You'll need to express your commitment to change and the supports and challenges that may affect your progress. There are no "right" or "wrong" answers—each person's situation is unique.

STEPS

For ease of use, we recommend you first take each template out of the binder and fill it in as you read through the steps. Each template can be found following the instructions and sample answers. (See page 13.)

STARTING POINT

1. **Why do you want to go through this process? Why now?** Record the reasons why you want to explore your career options. It might be that you don't like the work you are currently doing, or perhaps the management of your organization has changed and things that you liked about your organization no longer apply. You may like the organization you work for, but want to explore other positions. Or perhaps you foresee changes ahead in your job or organization and you want to be prepared just in case. There may be changes in your personal life—getting married, getting divorced, having a child or moving—that require you to make changes in your job. Or maybe you are finishing school and entering the workforce as a high-school or college graduate. Whatever your reasons are, write down why you are seeking something new.

ENDING POINT

2. **Primary outcome:** What is the main goal you want to reach after completing this process? Write down what you would like to accomplish. Is it a new job, a promotion, or the same position with a different industry or employer? Perhaps you are considering a return to school and you want to confirm that the program you choose will be most beneficial for your career goals. Whether it is job or school related, write down your main objective for completing *The Career Compass* process.
3. **Secondary outcomes:** What would you like to gain in addition to your primary outcome? For example, you may want to learn about different industries, to have a better understanding of careers that suit your personal preferences, or to discover where to look for new opportunities. Or, you may have wishes that relate to your personal life.
4. **Time frame:** Some individuals will begin this process only after the need to find a new job is immediate. Depending on the job market and your experience, a short goal may be possible, but for others it may take at least four to six weeks to find a new job. If you are completing this process in order to make long-range decisions, you may need six months, a year or more to make a transition. Record your time frame goal in the space provided.
5. **Resources/supports:** It is beneficial to identify the people, places and things that can help you through this process. If you hit a rough patch, your resources and supports will help get you back on track. Your resources and supports might include a career counselor or coach, your family members, friends or possibly coworkers. If you have been laid off, you may be receiving outplacement services or have a support group of other employees who were laid off with you. Other resources could include professional organizations or websites with employment information.

Simply talking with others will prove to be a great support and could create opportunities. We recommend that you familiarize yourself with the *Networking Map* (page 49) early in the process as you begin making connections with people. Keeping track of your contacts from the onset will greatly help you as you continue to expand your network.

6. **Potential challenges:** Write down any challenges that might make this process difficult. For example, you may have commitments at home that need to be handled in a timely manner. Or, you may be great at starting the process, but feel uncomfortable with certain steps and have trouble completing everything. There may be behaviors or attitudes you need to change in order to move forward. It is best to identify these issues so you will be prepared to deal with them when they appear.
7. **How will you commit to this process?** First, write down your level of commitment. If you have decided to do this on your own, you are most likely very committed to the outcome. However, if someone else is asking you to address your career—your family, employer or professor—you may not be as vested. Whatever your reasons, be honest with your level of commitment. If you are not very committed, perhaps there is someone who can help you see the value of making a change. Also, if you tell someone else that you are committing to the process you will become more accountable.

Next, write down what you can do to stay on task. You may want to complete *The Career Compass* steps in a few short weeks and make appointments with another person to review your completed templates. Or perhaps you and a friend could work through *The Career Compass* together, providing mutual support along the way. Regardless of your methods, write down what will keep you motivated.

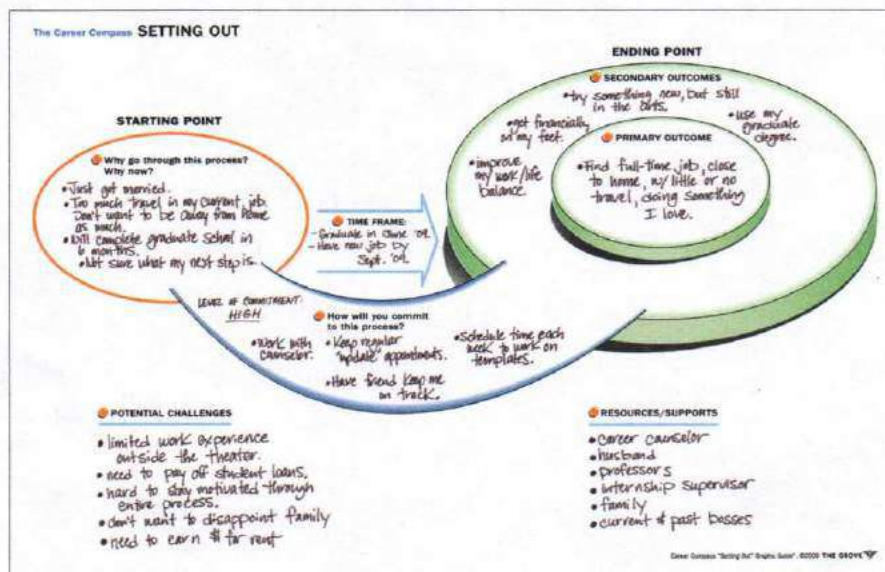
Your completed *Setting Out* template prepares you for the steps ahead. Keep in mind that nothing is set in stone. For instance, you may find that while going through the rest of *The Career Compass* you want to revisit your primary and secondary outcomes. Feel free to adjust these as you move along.

Use the “Notes” page following the template to capture any additional observations or thoughts.

Sample Answers for *Setting Out*:START
HERE

- 1. WHY GO THROUGH THIS PROCESS?:** Graduating from college; laid off; moved to new location; returning to work after having children; not happy in my current job.
- 2. PRIMARY OUTCOME:** New job in management; get master's degree; start my own business; move to New York; get a job that is a better fit for my interests.
- 3. SECONDARY OUTCOMES:** Take on more responsibility; travel less in my job; present at a conference; make more money.
- 4. TIME FRAME:** New job in 3 months; career change in 12 months; get internship this summer then new job within a year; be accepted in graduate school next spring.
- 5. RESOURCES/SUPPORTS:** Family; support group; friends; counselor; spouse; professional organizations; alumni associations; websites.
- 6. POTENTIAL CHALLENGES:** Money constraints; hard to find time to do this; fear that I won't like my new job; fear of being too ambitious; fear that I'm not qualified; fear of change.
- 7. COMMITMENT:** Commitment level=10. Will work with a career counselor; go to a job-search group; talk with my manager; work with a mentor; complete two templates each week.

A completed template might look like this:



STARTING POINT

● Why go through this process?
Why now?

● TIME FRAME:

● How will you commit
to this process?

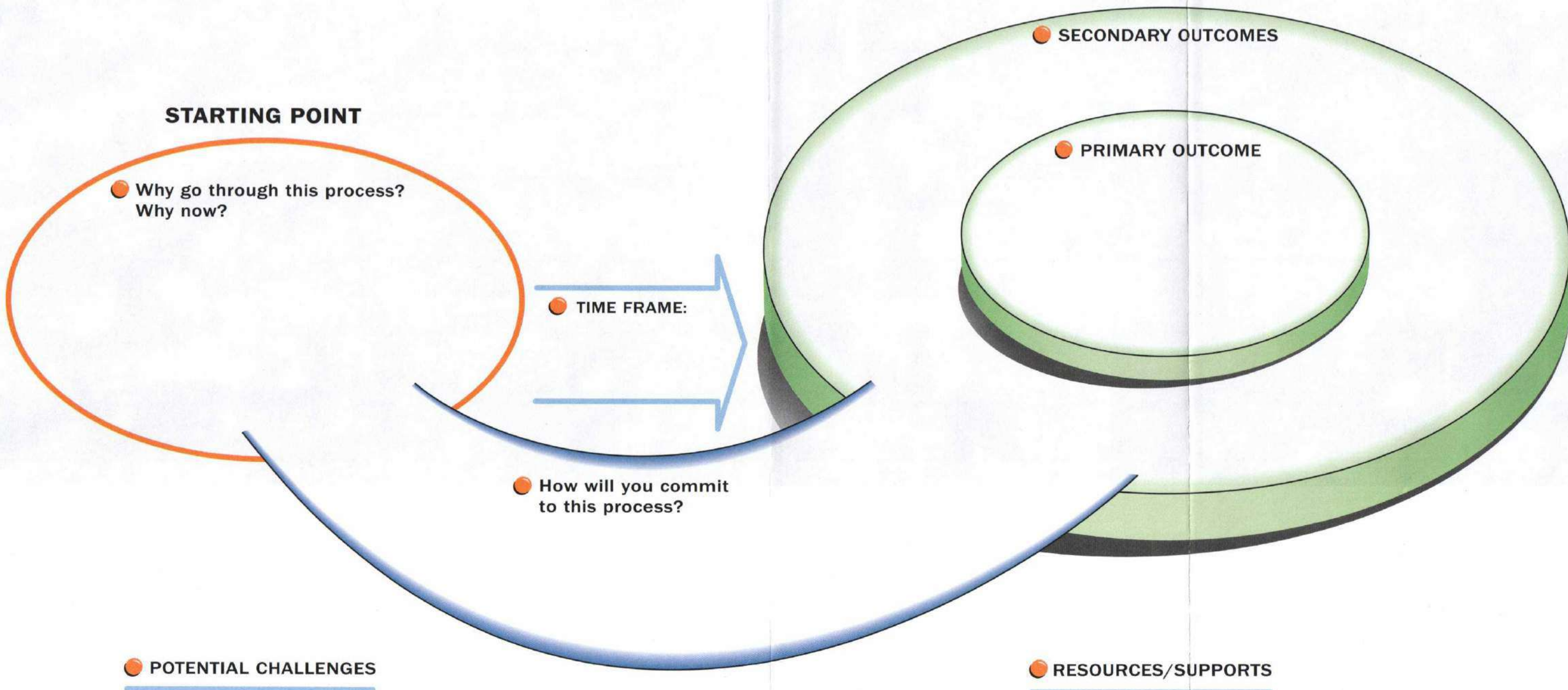
● POTENTIAL CHALLENGES

ENDING POINT

● SECONDARY OUTCOMES

● PRIMARY OUTCOME

● RESOURCES/SUPPORTS



Notes:

Stage 2

HISTORY

Now that you have begun to map your current situation and have taken your first steps forward in *Setting Out*, you will look back to your past. Mapping your educational, work and life experiences helps reveal where you are coming from, what has motivated you throughout your life, and especially what you have liked and disliked along the way. Learning from the past can help you craft a more ideal future.

By graphically charting your history, you may see patterns that you were unaware of. You may be surprised at the skills you have developed over the years. On the other hand, you may be amazed that you keep ending up in similar situations that are unsatisfying. Your *History* may also help you remember things that you once loved doing but haven't done in years, or experiences that you once found very fulfilling. For some, charting a *History* can be a challenging experience. If this is true for you, try to get the facts down without judgment. Keep in mind that this template can be a useful first step in building your resume.

*Learn from yesterday, live for today,
hope for tomorrow. The important thing
is not to stop questioning.*

Albert Einstein

HISTORY

Looking Back to Move Forward

The *History* template helps you review your career history in a creative yet organized manner. Charting your career history is an effective way to see patterns and build understanding about your development as you prepare for the future.

STEPS

We suggest following the sequence below for each horizontal stream of information, starting at the bottom and working your way up the template. Within each stream it is permissible and often desirable to hop around the timeline. Recording something that happened in 2000 may remind you of something that happened in 1995.

1. **Dateline:** Begin by putting dates on the dateline. Start at the far right with the current year. Work backward, one year at a time for the first few years, then increase the time between dates to two, five or ten years to, ideally, take the dateline back to high school. We suggest using multiple templates if your work history is extensive. (See the Appendix for an additional *History* template if needed.)
2. **Education:** Record both formal and informal education. Formal education includes high school, college and graduate school. Informal education refers to different types of professional development, such as workshops and conferences, as well as important books or magazines that have impacted you. Learning experiences on the job or in the community are also part of your education.
3. **Work Experience & Skills:** Chart your employment history and any volunteer work you may have done. Include job titles and a few words about the responsibilities involved. In addition, record any skills that were developed and any knowledge gained from these work experiences. You can use this information when you build your resume.
4. **Life Experiences:** Think of life experiences as the items that fill your scrapbook: the people, places, events and decisions that are noteworthy in your history.
 - 4a. **People & Places:** Chart the people and places that have made an impact on your life. People may include family members, friends, community members, coworkers, mentors, neighbors, and so on. Continue to fill in the template with the places you have lived or visited for significant amounts of time. Different homes, cities, states and countries are all relevant.
 - 4b. **Key Events & Big Decisions:** As you acknowledge significant people and places, let the flow of information lead to key events and decisions that have impacted your life. This is the place to reflect on major events in your life, both positive and negative. Events such as getting married, having children, moving to a new location, going back to school, dealing with health issues, buying a house, getting a divorce, caring for a sick relative and mourning a loss are all major milestones worthy of noting. External forces such as world events or economic trends may have had an impact on your life as well.
5. **Goals & Aspirations:** Record high-level inspirations and motivations that influenced your life at any given time. List career aspirations, hobbies, interests or any ambitions you had at any period in your life.

6. Insight: This is the space to reflect on information you have recorded for Steps 1 through 5.

6a. Reread the data and note your happiest moments by either putting a "+" sign next to them or by circling the items with a certain color pen. Note negative times in your history with a "-" sign or by circling with a different color pen.

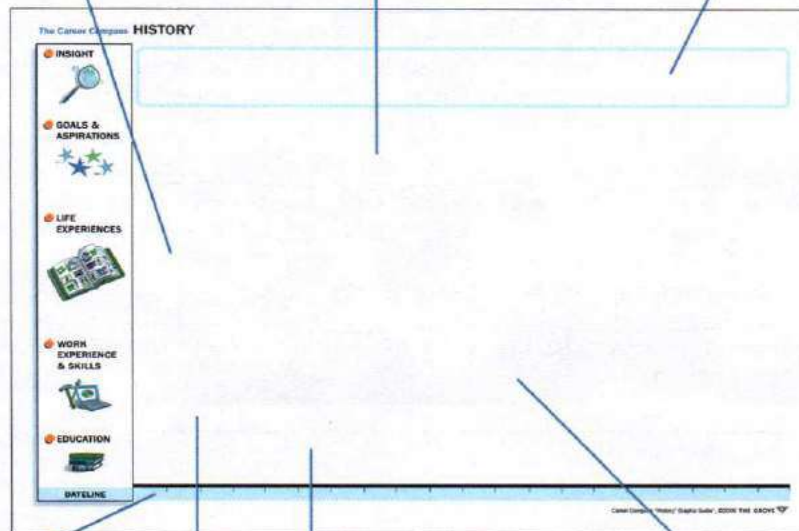
6b. Record the big ideas or themes you see in your history. Note common trends or patterns that emerge. You may learn what you wish to bring into the future and what you wish to leave behind. Ask yourself these questions to build deeper understanding: When did you take risks? What kind? What events helped you learn the most about yourself? Are there past ambitions that intrigue you? Were there any key events that influenced changes in work experience or goals? How did you make big decisions in the past?

Reviewing your *History* template with a counselor or trusted friend may help bring the big picture of your past into focus and move you forward in your career choices.

Use the "Notes" page following the template to capture any additional observations or thoughts.

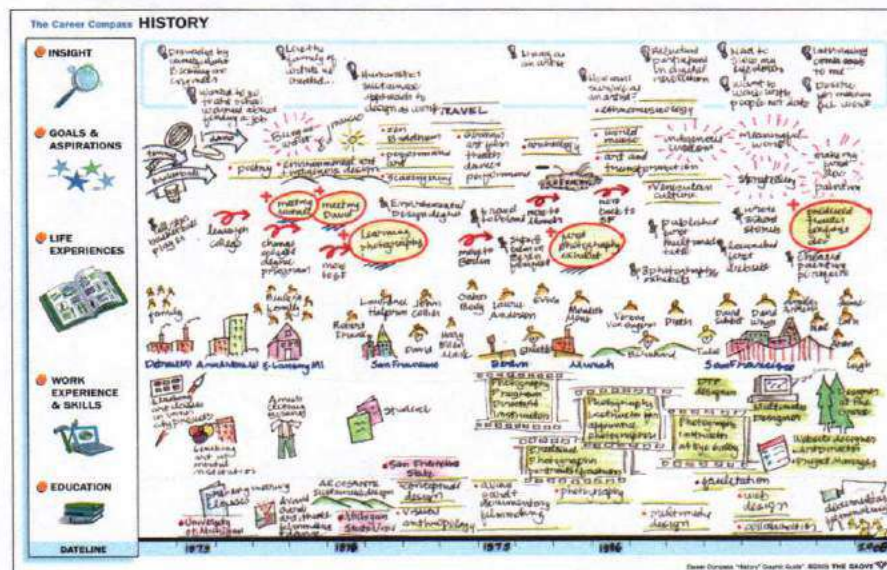
Sample Answers for History:

4. **LIFE EXPERIENCES:** I moved to Virginia. I had an influential college professor. I met my wife. I bought my first house. I broke my leg skiing. I lost a dear friend to cancer. Economic downturn.
5. **GOALS & ASPIRATIONS:** Becoming a lawyer; becoming a chef; traveling the world; playing guitar; photography; parenthood.
6. **INSIGHT:** I really enjoyed working in a social environment. I tend to move when I have personal problems. I was most fulfilled when I was being creative. I like taking on responsibility.

START
HERE

1. **DATELINE:** Fill in the years of your History starting from the right (current year) and working backward in time as you move to the left (high school). A person who graduated high school in 1989 would review years 1987 to the current year.
2. **EDUCATION:** I graduated from high school in 1989. I went to college from 1989–1993 at UCLA, majoring in political science. I took Spanish courses at City College in Dayton, Ohio. I went to cooking workshops.
3. **WORK EXPERIENCE & SKILLS:** I was a project manager. Responsibilities: account management, client relations, financial tracking. Skills developed: presenting, team management, client interfacing.

A completed template might look like this:



● **INSIGHT**



● **GOALS & ASPIRATIONS**



● **LIFE EXPERIENCES**



● **WORK EXPERIENCE & SKILLS**



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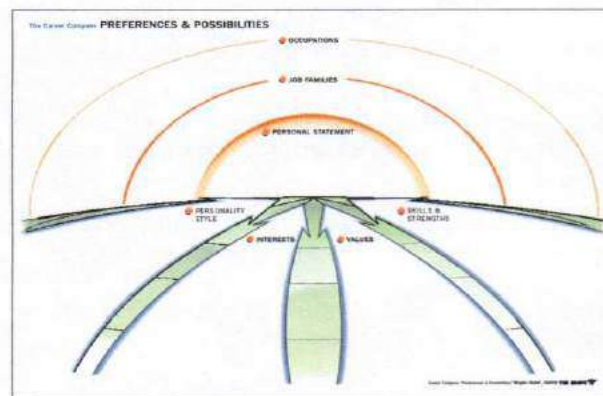
Notes:

Stage 3

PREFERENCES & POSSIBILITIES

By looking at your *History*, you may have learned about patterns in your life. You may be thinking about things you want to continue or develop and perhaps some things that you don't want to repeat. At the very least, we hope that you have recorded some of your likes and dislikes.

This next template, *Preferences & Possibilities*, will give you a fuller picture of your personal profile. The *Preferences & Possibilities* template is a holding space for all of the information gathered from various assessment tests (usually administered by career counselors) that provide a comprehensive understanding of who you are. Once you have completed assessment tests about your unique personality, interests, values, skills and strengths, you will be able to map job families and occupations that others like you gravitate toward.



We all have possibilities we don't know about. We can do things we don't even dream we can do.

Dale Carnegie

PREFERENCES & POSSIBILITIES

Your Profile Reveals Your Options

The *Preferences & Possibilities* template helps you synthesize results from a variety of career counseling assessment tools on a big-picture, comprehensive map. Each assessment may have its own workbook or report to help you discuss results with your career counselor. This template takes the evaluation process to the next level by revealing common themes and tendencies and helps you begin focusing your choices. By seeing a map of your "world" you are able to state who you are at this point in time, providing a strong foundation for your career plan.

STEPS

This template is designed to hold assessment results provided by other sources. Please request the appropriate tests from your career counselor or take tests online, or those offered in books, before completing this template. Each step references commonly used tests that will provide appropriate results. We highly recommend that you work with a counselor who is trained and qualified to administer and interpret career and personality assessments. However, if it is not possible to do so, we have listed some resources that are available to the public*. Results from these assessments change at different times in your life. It is important to have fresh results before beginning this template, even if you have done tests before. Once you have gathered your results, we suggest following the sequence below.

1. **Personality Style:** Using your results from the MBTI® or other personality assessment, write down your personality style in this area. Next, look up the explanations of your personality type and record key words and phrases that you feel are the most meaningful to you.

Commonly used assessment: Myers-Briggs Type Indicator® (MBTI)

Public resources: The Keirsey Temperament Sorter® II: <http://keirsey.com/>

Paul D. Tieger and Barbara Barron, *Do What You Are: Discover the Perfect Career for You Through the Secrets of Personality Type*, (4th ed. Little, Brown & Co., 2007).

Isabel Briggs Myers, *Gifts Differing: Understanding Personality Type*, (Davies-Black Publishing, 1995).

David Keirsey and Marilyn Bates, *Please Understand Me: Character & Temperament Types*, (5th ed. Prometheus Nemesis Book Company, 1984).

2. **Interests:** Using the results from an interest assessment, write down your one-, two-, or three-letter theme code or your general family of interests. For example, if your assessment indicates that you are Enterprising, Social, and Artistic, you would write those three words in the area provided for Interests. After reading the descriptions from your report or workbook, add words or phrases to the template that are relevant to you.

Commonly used assessment: Strong Interest Inventory® (Strong)

Public resources: Self-Directed Search by Dr. John Holland: <http://www.self-directed-search.com/>

Career Interests Game: <http://career.missouri.edu/students/explore/thecareerinterestsgame.php>

3. **Values:** Using a values card sort or list of values, identify the top ten values that are meaningful to you at this point in time. After writing down your top ten values, write a definition for each. Rather than going to the dictionary, ask yourself, "How does this value show up in my life? What does this mean to me?"

Commonly used assessment: Values-Driven Work™ Card Sort by NOVA, Knowdell Career Values Card Sort

Public resources: Quintessential Careers: http://www.quintcareers.com/workplace_values.html

Selfcounseling.com: <http://www.selfcounseling.com/help/personalsuccess/personalvalues.html>

* An Internet search for career assessments will provide you with many resources. Take care that many online assessments or quizzes are not scientifically valid or reliable and may not provide you with accurate information. It is advisable to work with a career counselor who is qualified or certified to administer assessments.

4. **Skills & Strengths:** Use this area to capture the skills and strengths that you currently have and would like to use in the future. You may also include skills you'd like to develop in the future.

Commonly used assessments: SkillScan, Knowdell Motivated Skills Card Sort, EUREKA's Motivated Skill Sort

Public resources: Authentic Happiness, hosted by Dr. Martin Seligman at University of Pennsylvania:

<http://www.authentichappiness.sas.upenn.edu/Default.aspx>

O*NET: <http://online.onetcenter.org/skills/>

StrengthsQuest™: <https://www.strengthsquest.com>

Marcus Buckingham and Donald Clifton, *Now, Discover Your Strengths*, (Free Press, 2001).

Tom Rath, *StrengthsFinder 2.0: A New and Upgraded Edition of the Online Test From Gallup's Now, Discover Your Strengths*, (Gallup Press, 2007).

5. **Job Families:** Before you consider specific occupations, write down broad job families that interest you, or job families that appeared in the personality, interest, values, skills and/or strengths assessments results. Job families are groups of occupations that share similar skills, training and credentials. O*NET allows you to look at several job families and their corresponding occupations. Record your top four or five on the job family "arc," allowing plenty of space in between them.

Commonly used assessment: MBTI Career Report

Public resource: O*NET: <http://online.onetcenter.org>

6. **Occupations:** From the Strong, MBTI, O*NET, or based on work with your counselor, write down the top eight occupations that correspond to your personality and/or interests. Some of these occupations may not appeal to you at the moment. However, after further research you may find that you have things in common with people who enjoy that work. You can eliminate occupations that aren't a good fit for you later. Record these occupations near the appropriate job family.

Commonly used assessment: MBTI Career Report, Strong

Public resource: O*NET: <http://online.onetcenter.org>

7. **Personal Statement:** This area of the template allows you to summarize the information you have collected through all of your assessments and discussion with your counselor. Begin by writing down three to four words that express the essence of who you are. You may find these words among the summaries you have written down for your personality style, interests, values and skills. Look for common themes in your assessment results. Next, brainstorm different ways of putting these words together to create a phrase that you could use to tell someone about yourself. This might also be used as an "elevator speech" or thirty-second commercial. Your statement may complete the sentence: "I am motivated by . . ." Or, you may want to consider how you would answer the following questions: "What gives me a sense of purpose?" "How do I want to make a difference through work?" You may want to start by listing bullets on a separate sheet of paper, then craft your sentence in several different ways before transferring your final statement to the template.

Your completed *Preferences & Possibilities* template is a valuable tool in the career process. On one page, you should have a clear picture of who you are and several career directions to explore.

Use the "Notes" page following the template to capture any additional observations or thoughts.

Sample Answers for *Preferences & Possibilities*:

7. PERSONAL STATEMENT:

I am motivated by working with people to solve complex problems, honestly and creatively, while making time for my life outside of work.

6. OCCUPATIONS:

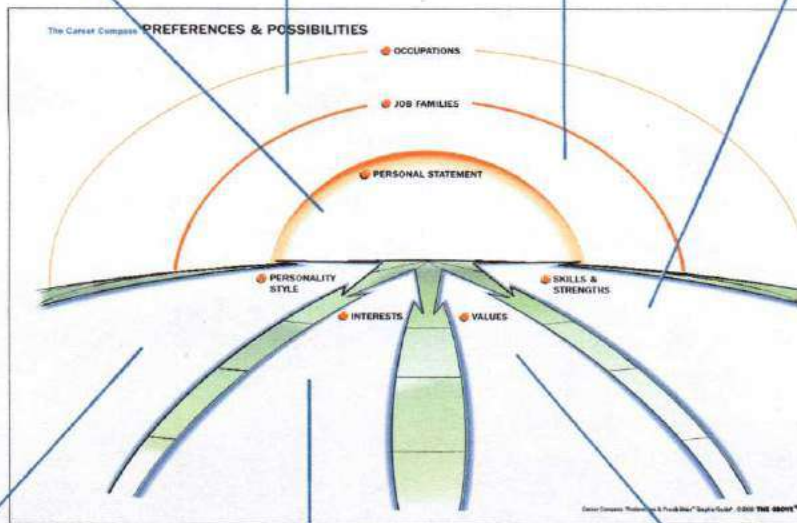
human resources manager, training specialist, marketing manager, teacher, fund-raiser, writer, journalist.

5. JOB FAMILIES:

Business and Financial Operations, Management, Community and Social Services, Communication, Business/Consulting.

4. SKILLS & STRENGTHS:

Listening, being open-minded, generating ideas, conceptualizing, teaching, and counseling.



START HERE

1. PERSONALITY STYLE:

Extroverted: I prefer working with groups. **Intuitive:** I see the big picture. **Feeling:** I care about how my decisions affect other people. I like harmony. **Judging:** I like structure and like to plan ahead.

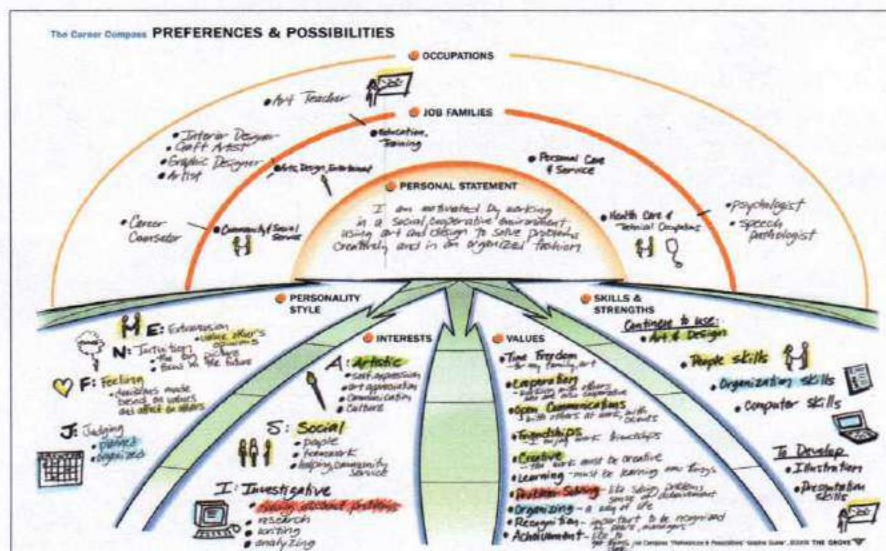
2. INTERESTS: Social: helping,

healing, supportive. **Enterprising:** leadership, persuading. **Artistic:** creative, original, independent.

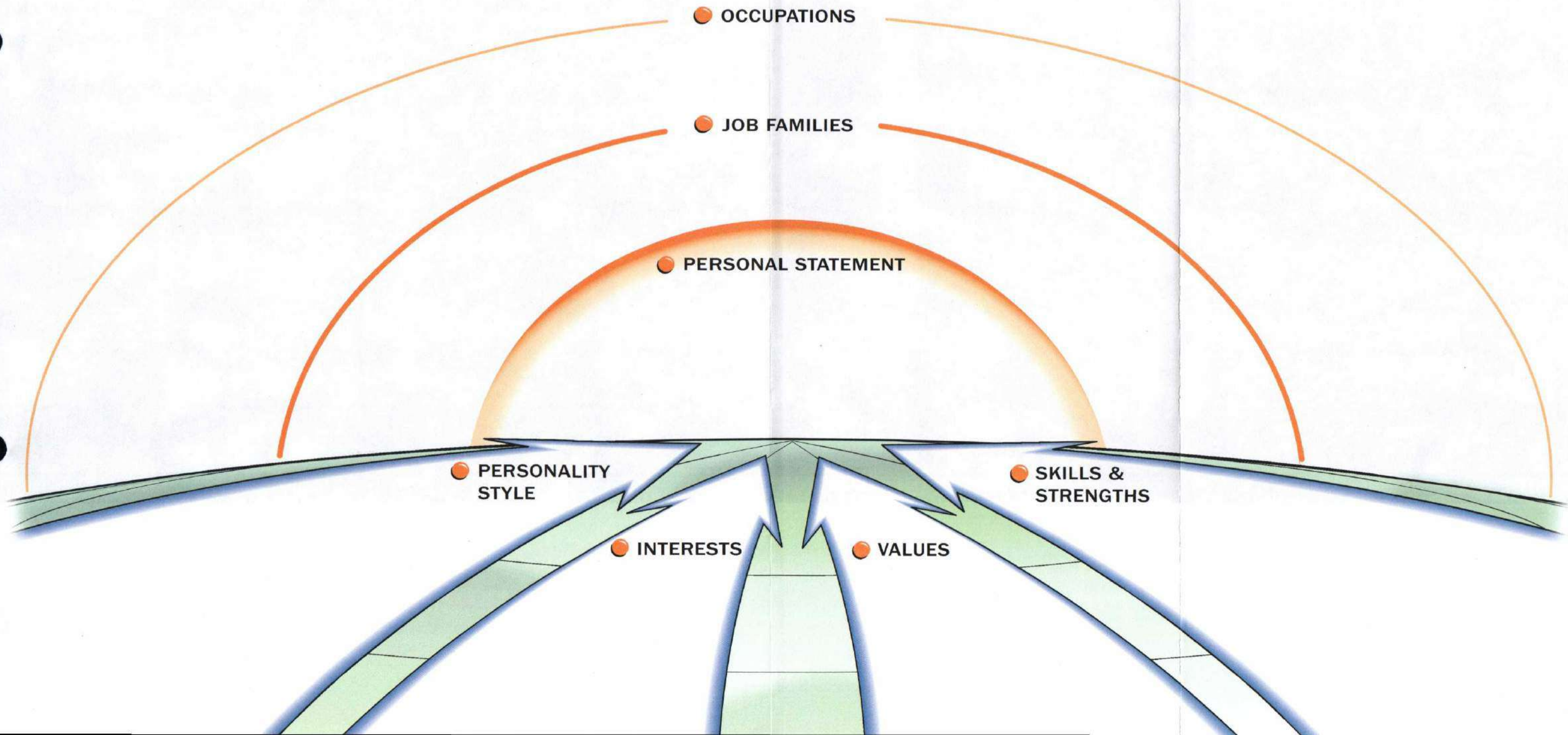
3. VALUES: Honesty and Integrity:

Need a setting where these are valued. **Help Others:** Either individually or in small groups. **Challenging Problems:** Like to solve complex questions. **Work/life Balance:** Need time for family, hobbies, and myself.

A completed template might look like this:



The Career Compass **PREFERENCES & POSSIBILITIES**



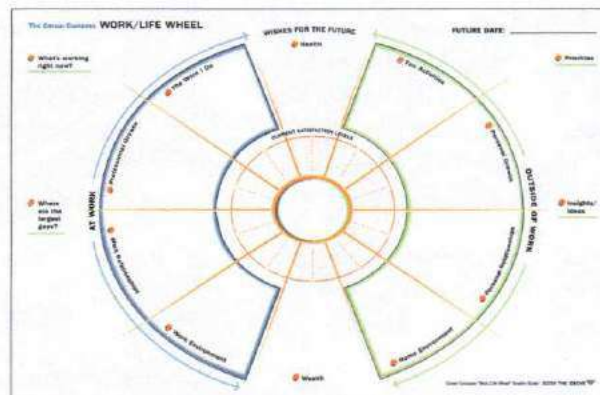
Notes:

Stage 4

WORK/LIFE WHEEL

With the big picture of your *Preferences & Possibilities* defined, you may have begun to imagine a different future. In the *Work/Life Wheel*, you will craft your most satisfying life. Consider not only what type of work situation would be ideal for you, but imagine what an optimal life outside of work might look like. Articulating your wishes for the future will help you define your direction.

With your work/life dream described, you can compare your wishes with your reality. This comparison, or gap analysis, will highlight areas of satisfaction and areas that need improvement. The result will be a clearer understanding of the priorities you want to set as you move forward.



Without leaps of imagination, or dreaming, we lose the excitement of possibilities. Dreaming, after all, is a form of planning.

Gloria Steinem

WORK/LIFE WHEEL

Assess Your Life and Set Priorities

The *Work/Life Wheel* template helps you consider the many aspects of your life and set priorities as you move forward. *Work/Life Wheel* first asks you to imagine every part of your life in a future, preferred state. Next you are asked to assess your current situation and identify the areas where you feel most fulfilled, and those that could improve. The self-awareness gained from this exercise helps you determine where to focus in the next stage of life and career.

STEPS

Allow yourself to think about your life through different lenses for this exercise. You'll begin by brainstorming future possibilities (in the outer ring), which requires an open-minded approach. Then, as you assess your current life (in the inner ring), you will need to be objective. Finally, as you set priorities, be focused and realistic.

1. **Future Date:** Date the template by choosing a time far enough in the future to stretch your thinking, but not so far that you can't visualize your life at that point. Your future date could take place anytime between six months and five years from today.
2. **Wishes for the Future:** Begin by reviewing the categories on the outer ring of the template. The template is organized with the left side designated "At Work" and the right side "Outside of Work," with the categories of Health and Wealth bridging both sides. Fill in the outer ring using the order suggested below, or start where you have the clearest wishes for your future. In this initial part of the exercise, free yourself from the constraints of today and focus your attention on the days ahead. Open up your thinking—imagine possibilities you may not have allowed yourself to envision before. Your completed *Preferences & Possibilities* may be a helpful reference for this exercise.
 - 2a. **Health:** Imagine yourself in excellent health. What would you be doing to take care of yourself? You may consider physical fitness, sleep, food choices, stress levels, mental health, and so forth.
 - 2b. **The Work I Do:** What would you love to be paid to do? If you could craft your own job description, what would it be? What kinds of things would you do in a day's work?
 - 2c. **Professional Growth:** Imagine that you have been progressing in your career. Are there new skills that you have learned? What have you accomplished? Are there hurdles that you have overcome?
 - 2d. **Work Relationships:** What do your ideal work relationships look like? Consider what type of boss, coworkers, associates and clients you would like to have. Would your work relationships also include friendships?
 - 2e. **Work Environment:** What is your ideal work environment like? Are you alone or working with a group of people? Are you in a small or large organization? Describe your imagined surroundings.
 - 2f. **Fun Activities:** What are you doing to have fun? Consider socializing, recreation and leisure activities, travel, entertainment, and relaxation. Often items that come up under Personal Growth may appear in this category, as well.
 - 2g. **Personal Growth:** Personal Growth is defined by each individual. Are there classes you want to take, a spiritual practice to develop, or a behavior or attitude change to work on? Or perhaps you have intellectual or creative pursuits you want to cultivate. In your future state, what have you accomplished?

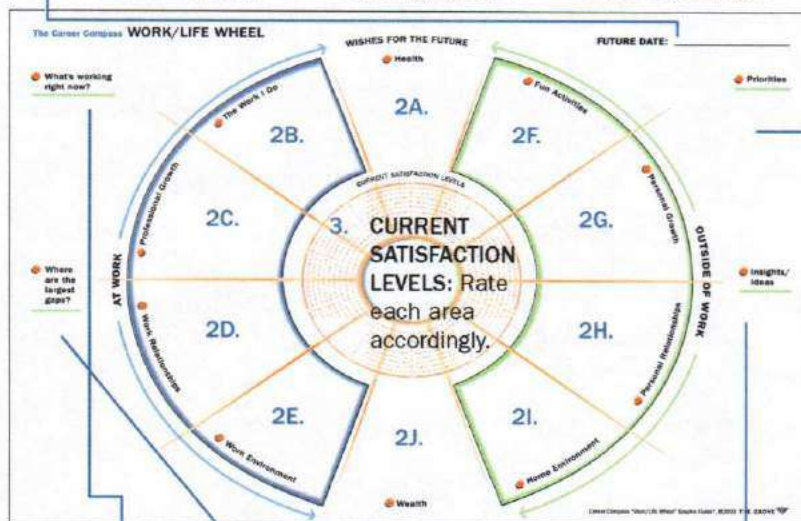
- 2h. Personal Relationships:** Consider the different relationships you have with significant others, family members or friends. Also take into account relationships that you don't have now, but may in the future. Although there are variables out of your control, how could you make your relationships as fulfilling as possible? Ultimately answer: What do you want from your personal relationships and what would that look like?
- 2i. Home Environment:** If your home environment supported your well-being, what would it be like? Would it be a completely different place, or your current home, but perhaps improved? Consider city or town, neighborhood, type of housing, your space, and the like. Describe your surroundings.
- 2j. Wealth:** Research has shown that money and happiness have a complicated relationship. Look over the other categories on the template and think about what is fulfilling for you. Now fill in the sentences: I need enough money to . . . I want enough money to . . .
- 3. Current Satisfaction Levels:** Now, with an objective but not overly critical mind set, begin to rate how you feel about each area of your life right now. Draw a line from the center outward to reflect your level of satisfaction on a scale of 1 to 10. One would be completely unsatisfied, 5 would be moderately satisfied, and 10 would be completely satisfied. Once you draw your line, you can shade each section if you wish.
- 4. What's Working Right Now?** Examine your current satisfaction levels and note the areas of your life that are most satisfying.
- 5. Where Are the Largest Gaps?** Now, look at your current satisfaction levels versus your wishes for the future and note the largest gaps from now to the future state. Think of gaps as opportunities for change.
- 6. Insights/Ideas:** Noting your gaps, is there anything you uncovered about yourself that you previously did not know or had not articulated? Do you have ideas about how to lessen the gaps? Consider what you may have learned in the *Preferences & Possibilities* exercise. Does knowledge about your personal traits shed any new light on areas of satisfaction or dissatisfaction?
- 7. Priorities:** As a final step, choose your top three to five priorities for the next stage of your life. It is very difficult to have complete satisfaction in every aspect of our lives at any given time. It can, in fact, make us unhappy trying to succeed in all areas. Think about where you want to focus your attention and where you will give yourself a break for this time period. Look back at your Insights/Ideas section—sometimes a hidden priority can show up as an insight.

Your completed *Work/Life Wheel* gives you a comprehensive picture of what is most important to you, in both your life at work and your life outside of work. The priorities you have set should provide a focused lens as you advance into research and decision-making.

Use the "Notes" page following the template to capture any additional observations or thoughts.

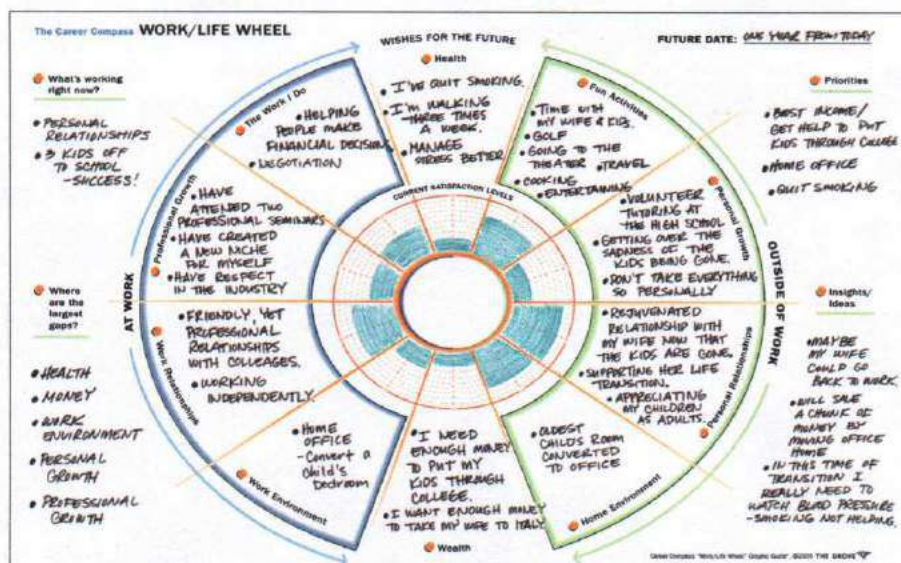
**START
HERE**

- | | | | | |
|--|--|---|---|---|
| <p>1. FUTURE DATE:
By my 30th birthday.</p> | <p>2A. HEALTH:
Feel strong, healthy. Stress levels down. Overcome insomnia.</p> | <p>2B. THE WORK I DO: Creative work, using intellectual and artistic skills.</p> | <p>2C. PROFESSIONAL GROWTH:
Creating and managing my own projects. A leader at work.</p> | <p>2D. WORK RELATIONSHIPS:
Friendly boss, coworkers, clients. Less conflict.</p> |
| <p>2E. WORK ENV'T:
Team-oriented, balance of casual and professional.</p> | <p>2F. FUN ACTIVITIES:
Time with friends, music, seeing art, travel abroad.</p> | <p>2G. PERSONAL GROWTH:
Improved painting and drawing skills.</p> | <p>2H. PERSONAL RELATIONSHIPS:
Spending quality time with my parents, siblings.</p> | <p>2I. HOME ENVIRONMENT:
Better art-making space.</p> |



- | | | | | |
|--|---|--|---|--|
| 2J. WEALTH:
Need enough money to cover expenses and have some fun. Save for a house. | 4. WHAT'S WORKING RIGHT NOW?:
Artistic development, social life, traveling. | 5. WHERE ARE THE LARGEST GAPS?: Current job doesn't suit me, work relationships are poor. | 6. INSIGHTS/IDEAS:
Haven't been considering professional growth nearly enough. Work affects health. | 7. PRIORITIES:
Get a creative job where I can grow, in an upbeat, friendly organization. |
|--|---|--|---|--|

A completed template might look like this:



The Career Compass **WORK/LIFE WHEEL**

WISHES FOR THE FUTURE

FUTURE DATE: _____

● Health

● What's working right now?

● Priorities

The Work I Do

● Fun Activities

CURRENT SATISFACTION LEVELS

● Personal Growth

OUTSIDE OF WORK

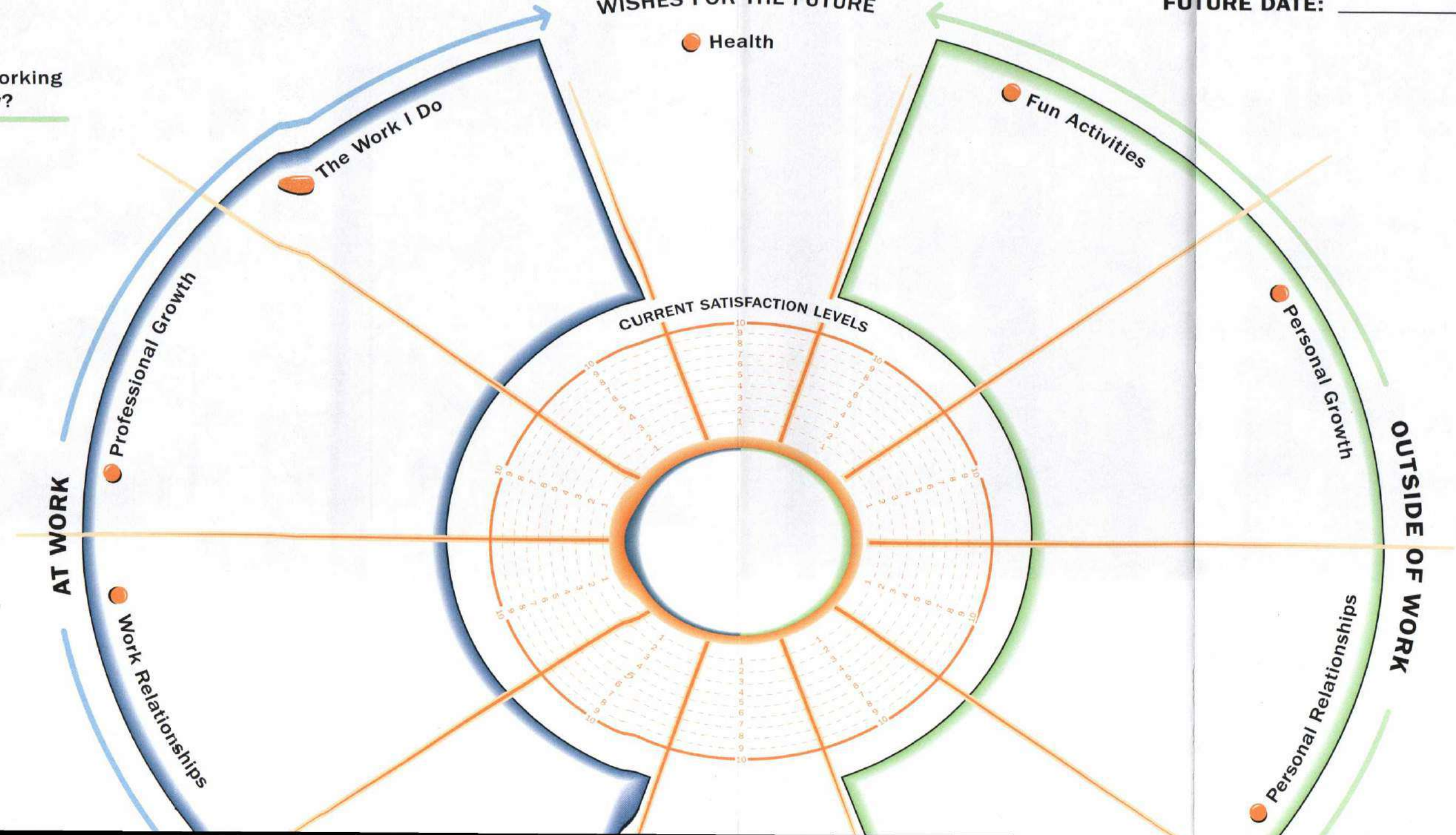
● Insights/Ideas

AT WORK

● Professional Growth

● Work Relationships

● Personal Relationships



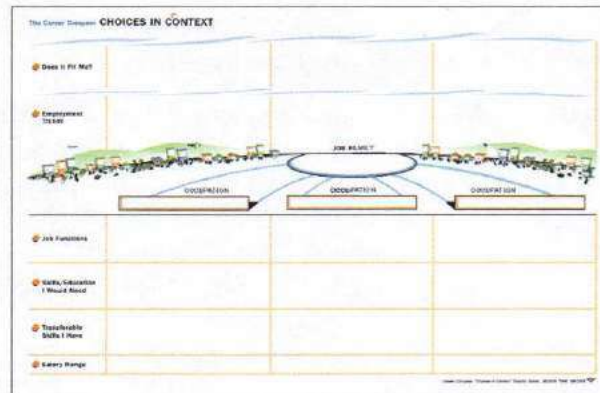
Notes:

Stage 5

CHOICES IN CONTEXT

Up to this point in *The Career Compass* process, you have primarily focused your thinking internally. Your *History* combined with your *Preferences & Possibilities* developed a picture of who you are. The *Work/Life Wheel* helped clarify your work and life wishes, and helped set priorities for moving forward. These exercises have built on one another to provide a solid foundation for the work ahead.

In the next phase of *The Career Compass*, the focus shifts to the external environment. With *Choices in Context*, you begin researching different career opportunities. You will cast a wide net, and then work on refining your options as you compare different occupations. *Choices in Context* will help you consider the context within which occupations relate to the larger job market and ultimately how occupations relate to you.



*In the long run, we shape our lives,
and we shape ourselves. The process
never ends until we die. And the choices
we make are ultimately our own
responsibility.*

Eleanor Roosevelt

CHOICES IN CONTEXT

Investigate Your Prospects

The *Choices in Context* template helps you compare occupations and eventually focus your career prospects. It helps you look at different levels of information: the occupation itself, the larger context of employment trends, and whether or not the occupation fits you personally. The template is designed to compare three occupations per template. Use additional *Choices in Context* templates (located in the Appendix) to look at additional job families and occupations.

STEPS

By completing the *Preferences & Possibilities* template, you should have a number of job families and occupations to research. For this template, you will be doing research online; reading books, magazines and newspapers; and having conversations with individuals in selected occupations. If you know someone working in a field or occupation that interests you, take the time to read through the instructions for the *Networking Map* (page 50). We recommend you start tracking names on the *Networking Map* as soon as you begin contacting people.

Choices in Context works well with the Occupational Informational Network (O*NET), which was developed for the United States Department of Labor and can be found online at <http://online.onetcenter.org>. Use O*NET, or other job search website, and follow the sequence below.

1. **Job Family:** Look back at your *Preferences & Possibilities* template and select a job family that you would like to explore. To reiterate, a job family is a group of occupations that share similar skills, training and credentials. Write a job family in the center of the template, for example: "Business and Financial Operations" or "Administrative Support." O*NET has a comprehensive list of job families.
2. **Occupations:** Again, look back at your *Preference & Possibilities* template and transfer three occupations that correspond to your chosen job family, one for each column. For example, if your job family is "Healthcare Practitioners and Technical Occupations," then occupations under that heading could be "Speech Pathologist," "Psychologist," and "Occupational Therapist." Often we choose job titles that are already familiar to us. This is a good opportunity to look at jobs that you don't know. Choose at least one specific job title that is new to you. If you don't have three occupations for your chosen job family, use the free columns to fill in related occupations you uncover through research. Or, you can note related occupations as you look up a particular job and use additional templates to research those if need be.
3. **Job Functions:** Start by researching one occupation and summarizing its job title and tasks. Don't worry about getting all of the information down; just note words and phrases that outline the scope of the job. A good summary of the job function may be found on O*NET's online summary report for each occupation. You will find more information under "Work Activities." Remember to record information about various settings in which an occupation can be found.
4. **Skills/Education I Would Need:** Some jobs require special training, education, internships, certification or licensing. In some areas, higher education or work experience may be necessary to compete with others in that market. Search on the Internet with the phrase: "qualifications required for (occupation)." On O*NET, search the sections titled "Knowledge" and "Job Zone." Also on O*NET, take a look at "Skills," "Abilities" and "Work Styles" and note areas to develop. Keep track of the highlights, rather than writing down every detail. Don't worry if you don't currently have the skills or education you will need. This activity lets you see what additional work is needed to be employable for that job.

5. **Transferable Skills I Have:** While investigating “Knowledge,” “Skills,” “Abilities” and “Work Styles” on O*NET, write down your current capabilities that match this occupation.
6. **Salary Range:** Using websites such as online.onetcenter.org, or www.salary.com, as well as job ads found in periodicals, research the salary range and median salary for each occupation. Be sure to read the job description carefully to make sure you are writing down the correct range for the job. Also, pay attention to salary level and how it corresponds to experience.
7. **Employment Trends:** Now that you’ve recorded details about the occupation, take your research to a higher level and investigate the occupation in the larger context of the job market. O*NET provides data that indicates the job outlook for occupations on both the national and state levels in “Wages and Employment Trends.” Is this profession growing, and if so, at what rate? In which states is the occupation growing fastest? Also take into consideration economic and political trends that may affect this occupation. Cultural needs, technological innovations and new legislation are examples of trends that can either boost or threaten an occupation.
8. **Does It Fit Me?:** Look back at your *Preferences & Possibilities* template and read your “Personal Statement.” Does this occupation fit with your personality style, interests and values? Write down similarities you see with your preferences and those listed under “Work Styles,” “Work Values” and “Interests” for this occupation on O*NET. Also take note of key differences. Look at your *Work/Life Wheel* template. Will this job have a positive or negative impact on your wishes for the future? Does the job excite you? Do you see challenges or opportunities with the occupation? Look over all of the information in this completed column and ask yourself, “Is this job a fit for who I am?” You are the only one who can answer this question. Your answer may be “yes” but only with certain conditions, such as if you were to work in a certain type of organization. Or your answer could be a clear “no.”
9. **Final Evaluation:** Complete all three columns and as many additional *Choices in Context* templates as necessary to make a comprehensive comparison. (Additional templates can be found at the back of this binder). As a final evaluation for this stage of *The Career Compass* process, look over all of the occupations you have researched and choose your top two or three.

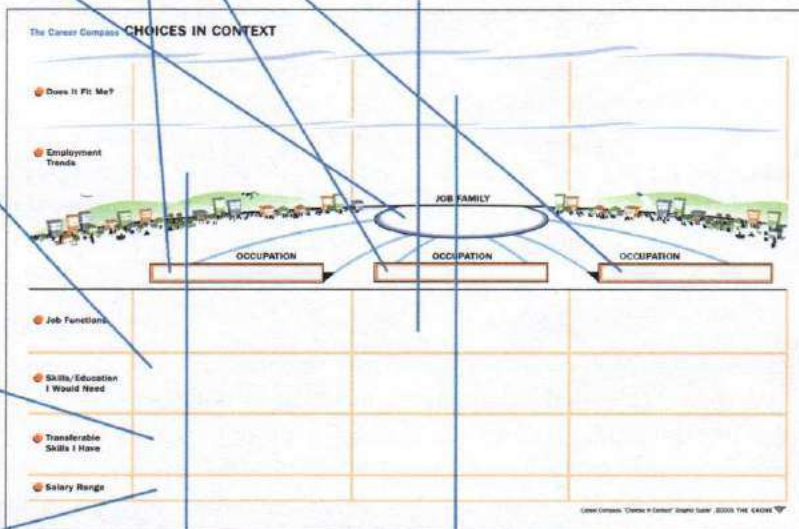
After completing one or more of the *Choices in Context* templates, you should have two or three occupations that seem like viable options. You will probably be intrigued to learn more and, if you haven’t already done so, start talking to some people in this profession. You will investigate these occupations further in the following *Networking Map* and *A Day in the Life* exercises.

Use the “Notes” page following the template to capture any additional observations or thoughts.

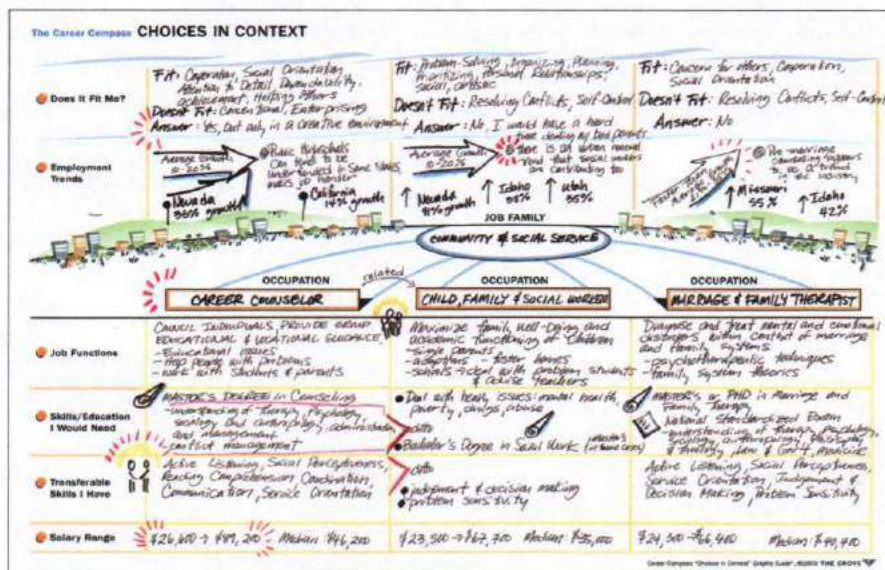
Sample Answers for Choices in Context:

START
HERE

- 1. JOB FAMILY:**
Education, Training and Library.
- 2. OCCUPATIONS:**
Elementary school teacher, librarian, curator.
- 3. JOB FUNCTIONS:**
Managing library materials.
—readers' advisory services
—strategic research
—filtering info
—databases and info systems
- Settings:** Public libraries, schools, colleges and universities, museums, corporations, government agencies, law firms, nonprofits, and healthcare.
- 4. SKILLS/EDUCATION I WOULD NEED:**
Administration & mgmt. training, personnel and HR training. May require M.A., Ph.D. or law degree, depending on setting.
- 5. TRANSFERABLE SKILLS I HAVE:**
English: reading comprehension, speaking. People skills: Active listening, teaching, service orientation. Computer skills.
- 6. SALARY RANGE:**
\$30,000 to \$84,000. Median: \$47,000.
- 7. EMPLOYMENT TRENDS:**
Slower growth projected (0–9%). So. Carolina and NV have the highest growth rates. Internet is affecting this occupation.
- 8. DOES IT FIT ME?:**
Characteristics that fit me: Independence, relationships, artistic, investigative.
Characteristics that don't fit me: Conventional, working with public may be difficult. Answer: Only partially.



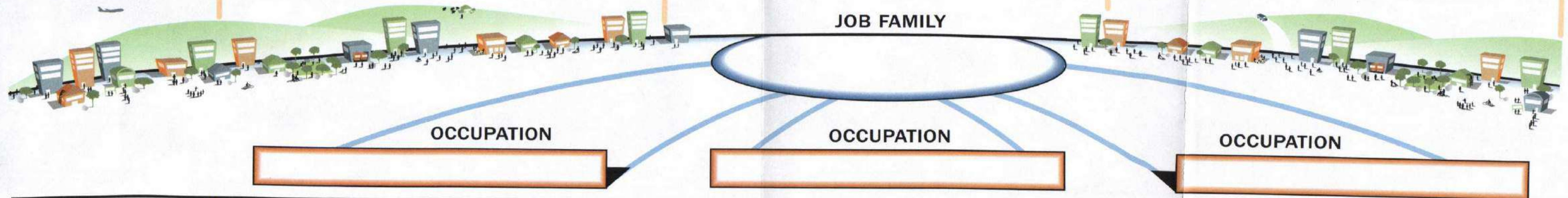
A completed template might look like this:



The Career Compass CHOICES IN CONTEXT

Does It Fit Me?

Employment Trends



Job Functions

Skills/Education I Would Need

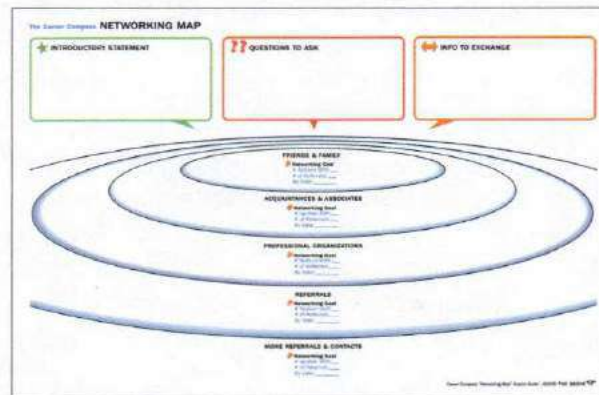
Notes:

Stage 6

NETWORKING MAP

For the *Choices in Context* template, you were most likely looking at secondary sources of research such as the Internet, magazines and books. With the *Networking Map*, you will continue to learn about occupations and the job market, but through primary research—by talking to people one on one. You may have already begun to discuss your career interests with family, friends or even some new acquaintances. If this is true, you've already started networking.

Networking is done for many reasons: to conduct informational interviews, to let others know of your job search, or to develop relationships that will help you further your career. The *Networking Map* helps you plan and track your networking efforts as well as develop your networking skills. Because networking can be daunting to some, this exercise helps you prepare yourself with the right materials, conversation points and questions to make talking to others easier. The benefits of networking are critical to any career change—you will gain crucial knowledge that isn't available from secondary sources, and you may make the right connection that lands you a job.



*The art and science of asking questions
is the source of all knowledge.*

Thomas Berger (novelist)

NETWORKING MAP

Organize Your Communication Efforts

The instructions below are primarily for someone beginning to network through informational interviews; however, as you become more focused on one occupation, your networking may change from general research to job hunt to continued career development. At whatever stage you are with networking, your *Networking Map* will keep you on track.

STEPS

Evaluate the data you have collected thus far in *The Career Compass* process. Before you begin networking, it is important to know who you are and which occupation(s) you are interested in. Plan on conducting many informational interviews for the two or three occupations you selected in the *Choices in Context* template. The *Networking Map* is designed to organize, but not necessarily contain, all of your communication details. Be aware that the information you gather through networking will be used in the following *Career Compass* templates: *A Day in the Life*, *Path Exploration* and *Action Plan*. Make sure to keep good notes of each conversation.

Materials to Prepare: Since you never know when an opportunity will appear, it is important to be organized before you start contacting others.

Resumé: While an informational interview is not a job interview, you may have the opportunity to share your resume. (See the Appendix for resources that will help you create a resumé.)

Business Cards: If you are currently employed, be sure to bring your business cards with you or take time to create your own business cards.

Record-Keeping System: It's a good idea to create a record-keeping system for detailed information. Whether you keep records on your computer or in this binder, you'll want to capture information that would allow you to reconnect at a later date. Information you keep should include the name and contact information of the individual; his or her company's name, position and area of expertise; date of the initial call; referrals from this contact; key points you learned in the meeting; any follow-up necessary, date you sent your thank-you note, and a follow-up date.

- 1. Introductory Statement:** This brief statement helps start a conversation. It should include your name, what you are currently doing or have done recently, how you found the individual and why you would like to talk to the individual. Begin by writing a draft of your introductory statement, then practice it out loud, and revise it until you feel natural saying it to yourself. Once you are happy with your statement, add it to your map. Once you have your introduction solidified, you will be able to tailor it to each person you talk to.
- 2. Questions to Ask:** Before contacting individuals, be sure to create a list of eight to ten questions. You may want to have three to four questions that you ask everyone to help compare answers. As you meet more people, you'll find some of the questions work better than others and you may want to revise your list. It's better to have more questions than you'll need, but don't feel that you need to ask all of them. Relax and go with the flow of the conversation. (See sample questions on page 55.)
- 3. Info to Exchange:** Consider or research information you can share. It may be a recent article you've read, a good book, information about a future conference or information that you already possess. Offering to send an article or website url is a great way to follow up. Keep in mind that you want to not only be making contacts, but building relationships that may benefit you and your entire network in the future.

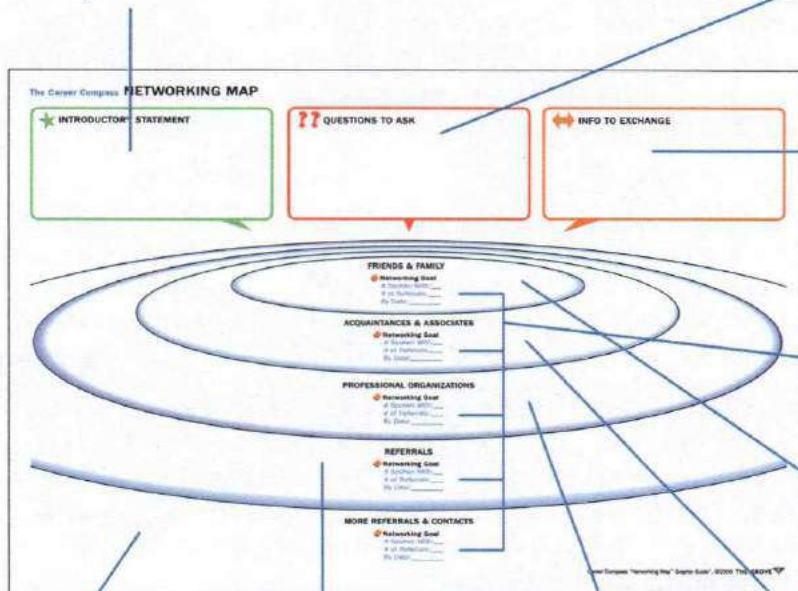
4. **Networking Goals:** As you set out to build your network, each ring on the template asks you to set goals. The number of people you talk to when you first begin networking may be modest. However, as you build your network, your goals will become more significant. For example, your goal for Friends & Family may be to talk to four people and get four referrals in one week. Your goal for Acquaintances & Associates may be to talk to twelve people and get twenty-four referrals in two months. Realistically determine the date by which you would like to accomplish each goal. It may be difficult to find a time when both you and your networking contacts can meet, so keep that in mind when selecting your goal dates.
5. **Friends & Family:** Often we overlook those closest to us as networking opportunities. However, if you're new to networking or just starting again, they are the best place to begin. Write down some individuals you will feel comfortable talking with. This is a good place to practice your communication skills. Be sure to take it seriously—these individuals may have wonderful contacts for you. Put a date next to each person you speak to. Record any referrals you get in the referral ring. If possible, draw a line from the original contact to his/her referrals.
6. **Acquaintances & Associates:** Now that you've practiced your skills, it's time to move on to other people you may not know as well. These could be social acquaintances whom you have met or will meet at a party. Past or present teachers can make great contacts. Those around you in your workplace might be helpful as well. Down the line, they may let you know of a job opening in their department or division. When considering associates don't forget vendors, people you do business with and, if appropriate, your customers.
7. **Professional Organizations:** Look into associations or events that interest you. You may share information you've learned through networking and research about the industry. As you distribute resumés and business cards, ask others for their business cards so you can reach them later. Write the date you received the card and where and how you met that contact.
8. **Referrals:** This circle allows you to capture the many referrals you'll be given. Track the person who referred you to a contact by writing his/her name in parentheses, or by drawing a line on the template to show the connection. When introducing yourself, remember to include the name of the person who referred you.
9. **More Referrals & Contacts:** The wonderful thing about networking is constantly increasing your connections. Keep track of the referrals you get from other referrals. You may also try contacting people you've read about or whose work you admire. You may be surprised by the number of people who are willing to help you.
10. **Follow-through:** It is very important to thank those who have taken the time to speak with you. You will also find that the strength of your network depends on your follow-through efforts. Keeping in touch with people will boost your potential for opportunities. Your network of individuals will support not only job searches but continued learning. Some individuals who have similar jobs and challenges may decide to create communities of practice and meet informally once a month to share information.

Networking is an ongoing process and is a key to keeping your options open. You should continue to work your *Networking Map* as you complete the remaining *A Day in the Life*, *Path Exploration* and *Action Plan* templates. In addition, you should continue to cycle back to your *Networking Map* as you advance further in the career-planning process. Even after you take a new or different job, keep in mind that continuing to build your network can greatly help you manage your career.

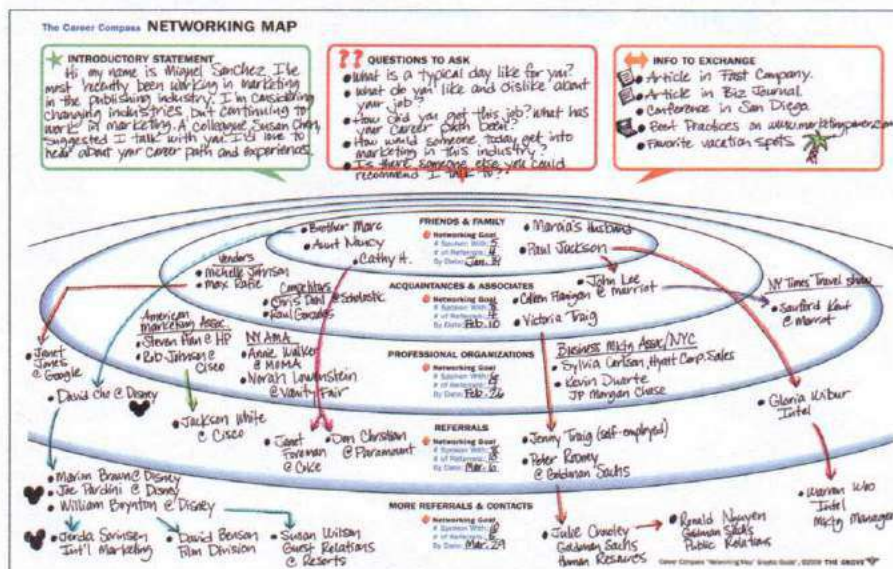
Sample Answers for Networking Map:

START
HERE

1. **INTRODUCTORY STATEMENT:** Hello, my name is Jane Johnson. I'm currently working as an information technology technician at XYZ Company. I'm exploring career options in the healthcare field and my friend Bob Jones recommended that I get in touch with you for an informational interview. I'd like to meet with you for about thirty to forty-five minutes. Is there a time in the next few weeks that will work for you?
2. **QUESTIONS TO ASK:** What is a typical day like for you? What do you like about your job? What do you dislike? What type of skills does someone in your job need to have in order to succeed? What was your career path?
3. **INFO TO EXCHANGE:** Newspaper article, magazine article, information about upcoming conference or workshop, good book on a relevant topic.
4. **NETWORKING GOALS:** Speak with 4 people, get 2 referrals by March 1; etc.
5. **FRIENDS & FAMILY:** Cousin, aunt, grandfather, good friends of the family, friends from school.
6. **ACQUAINTANCES & ASSOCIATES:** Ex-coworker, colleague, neighbor, friend at church, professor, fellow alumnus.
7. **PROFESSIONAL ORGANIZATIONS:** Member of an association, people you meet at workshops and conferences.
8. **REFERRALS:** Your first tier of referrals—the contacts you get from the first three rings.
9. **MORE REFERRALS:** Your second tier of referrals—use as your referrals grow.



A completed template might look like this:



The Career Compass **NETWORKING MAP**

★ **INTRODUCTORY STATEMENT**

?? **QUESTIONS TO ASK**

↔ **INFO TO EXCHANGE**

FRIENDS & FAMILY

● **Networking Goal**
Spoken With: ____
of Referrals: ____
By Date: ____

ACQUAINTANCES & ASSOCIATES

● **Networking Goal**
Spoken With: ____
of Referrals: ____
By Date: ____

PROFESSIONAL ORGANIZATIONS

● **Networking Goal**
Spoken With: ____
of Referrals: ____
By Date: ____

REFERRALS

● **Networking Goal**

Sample Questions for Networking and Informational Interviews

QUESTIONS ABOUT THE JOB

- Tell me what a “typical” day, week and month look like for you.
- What do you like about your job? What do you dislike?
- What type of skills does someone in a position like yours need in order to succeed? How did you acquire the necessary skills and knowledge?
- What was your path to this job? How would someone entering this field get a job today?
- Where do you go next? What is your next career step?

QUESTIONS ABOUT THE COMPANY

- What do you like about working for this organization? What do you dislike?
- How do the employees have fun? Do you celebrate accomplishments, anniversaries? Do you socialize outside the workplace?
- How are decisions made?
- Do you have regular performance reviews? Are they formal or informal? (Tell me about your performance-management system?)
- What type of training does the organization provide?
- How is excellent performance rewarded and acknowledged?
- Who is the most important stakeholder for your business: employee, customer, or shareholder?

QUESTIONS ABOUT THE INDUSTRY

- What areas of this industry are growing? Which are declining?
- What do you see as challenges to the industry in the next three to five years?
- Who do you feel are the trendsetters—the people to watch—in this industry?
- Are you a member of any professional organizations?
- What would you recommend for someone who is entering this profession or industry?
- What magazines and trade journals do you read to keep current on trends and industry information?

Stage 7

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Now that you've done a fair amount of research, and you've begun getting additional first-hand information through networking, you are ready for the next step: imagining what it would be like to spend a day in an occupation.

At this point in the process, you should have a clearer idea of the one or two careers or career shifts to pursue. For this template, not only will you be imagining what your life would be like at work, you will also take into consideration what a career choice would mean for your life outside of work. *A Day in the Life* is an opportunity to craft as well as test your ideas about what your ideal job would be like. You might paint a picture of the perfect job and corresponding life situation on your first try, or it may take you several tries to find the right ingredients for you at this point in life. Take your time and create a detailed image of your desired future.

The form is titled "A DAY IN THE LIFE" and is designed to look like an open notebook. It includes various sections for detailing a day's activities, from pre-work to after-work, and includes fields for occupation, organization name, salary, and benefits.

I have learned, that if one advances confidently in the direction of his dreams, and endeavors to live the life he has imagined, he will meet with a success unexpected in common hours.

Henry David Thoreau

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Experience an Occupation

A Day in the Life allows you to imagine yourself in an occupation. For this template you will be describing your day from the moment you wake up to when you go to bed. Use as much concrete data about your chosen occupation as you can. Informational interviewing—actually speaking to someone who is in the occupation—is highly recommended.

STEPS

By completing the *Choices in Context* template and working on your *Networking Map*, you should have narrowed down your occupation choices (or career moves) to two or three. Use the *A Day in the Life* exercise to fully explore each one. You may need to fill in several *A Day in the Life* templates until you find the right fit for you. (You can find extra templates in the Appendix).

1. **Occupation & Organization:** Choose the occupation that most interests you and record its name at the top of the page. Also, choose a specific organization you are interested in researching.
2. **Pre-Work Activities:** Picture yourself asleep and the alarm goes off. What time is it? What time do people doing this occupation usually arrive at work? For most people it would be morning, but for a few the work day may begin in the afternoon or the evening. Think about where you'd like to live if different from where you are now—what city, neighborhood, apartment, house and so on. Are you living alone or with others? What activities are part of your morning routine? What clothes do you wear to work? How long is your commute and what type of transportation are you using? This scenario may or may not reflect your current situation.
3. **Work Schedule:** First look at the **Annual Calendar** at the top of the day planner. Highlight the days of the week in each month that you would be working. Is this a Monday-through-Friday occupation? Is there weekend work? Is this occupation project-based? Then fill in when a typical **Work Day Begins** and when the **Work Day Ends**. Are the hours flexible? Is there the possibility of overtime? Also record a time when you get to take a **Break** and imagine how you might be spending your break—socializing, exercising, attending a class, etc.
4. **Environment:** Picture your workplace. Is it in the city in a large high-rise, or perhaps in the country in a small building? Is it a large or small organization? Do you work in an office, and if so, what kind of office? Do you work in a cubicle? Do you work outside?
5. **Culture:** Research the organization on the Internet and explore its website. Most organizations include information about their mission, values and products or services. Talk to someone in the organization to get a clearer sense. Is the culture highly professional, with employees wearing suits on a daily basis, or is the culture more casual? Is it stable and secure or fast-paced and high-risk? Do people work their way up the ranks, or do people tend to come and go based on project needs? Is the atmosphere competitive or collaborative?
6. **Coworker & Customer Interaction:** Do you work independently or in a team? Are you part of a large department or work group? Whom do you report to, and do others report to you? Who are your customers? How do you interact with them?
7. **Everyday Duties:** What work do you do on a daily basis? What types of projects do you work on?

8. **Other Responsibilities:** Are there duties that you would fulfill on a weekly or monthly basis? Research to find opportunities for becoming involved in projects that interest you specifically, such as a community-service project. Does the job include travel?
9. **Skills Used:** What skills are you using in your job? What knowledge do you need to do your job well? On the *Choices in Context* template you looked at all the skills used in the occupation. However, the position at a specific organization may be a bit different. Record pertinent information for this organization.
10. **Technologies Used:** Record the technology you use on the job. Are you learning a new software program or working with tools you've never used before?
11. **After-Work Activities:** Use this space to write down what happens once you leave work. How long is your commute? Do you go to the gym or play in a sports league? Are you taking evening classes? Do you go out with coworkers or meet friends after work? Do you have family commitments? Once you get home, how are you spending your evening? And finally, what time are you going to bed?
12. **Salary & Benefits:** Write down the salary range for this occupation and, if possible, in this particular organization (www.salary.com can help with general salary information). Include the benefits offered with this job at this company. You may be able to find this information on the company's website. Examples of benefits that may be offered include health, dental, vision, 401(k), paid vacation and paid sick leave.
13. **What Do You Love About Your Job?** Looking over the template you have just completed, pick out the top three to five things you like most about this job. You can receive insightful answers from informational interviews about what people love about their jobs. Ask yourself, "Are these same things important to me?"
14. **What Are Your Challenges or Anxieties?** Look over the completed template and pick out the top three to five areas that you believe will be a challenge for you or concern you.
15. **Final Evaluation.** After completing this template, you should know if the occupation is one that would fit you. Ask yourself these questions: Can I imagine being happy in this occupation? Would I be content in this occupation, but perhaps in another organization? Would I need to make some adjustments to my life outside of work if I had this job?

Look back at your *Preferences & Possibilities* template. Does the job match who you are?

Then look back at your *Work/Life Wheel* template. Does the job fit with the priorities you set?

Use the "Notes" page to record thoughts regarding these questions.

Complete at least one other *A Day in the Life* template to make an informed choice about the occupation or career move you want to pursue. Repeat this exercise until you find a match that motivates you. (See Appendix for additional templates.)

After completing this stage of *The Career Compass* process, you should have a clear sense of direction. Having an image of where you are headed is a big step in moving toward your destination.

Sample Answers for A Day in the Life:

START
HERE

- OCCUPATION & ORGANIZATION:** Outdoor school educator, REI.
- PRE-WORK ACTIVITIES:** Wake up 6 a.m. Live in San Francisco, Victorian apartment with friends in Cole Valley. Go for coffee, bagel, ride my bike to work—20 minutes.
- ENVIRONMENT:** Working in nature! Various locations in Bay Area.
- CULTURE:** Cooperative, dedication to environmental stewardship, outdoor adventure, pride.
- COWORKER & CUSTOMER INTERACTION:** Teaching with other outdoor educators. Meeting other outdoor enthusiasts.
- EVERYDAY DUTIES:** Gathering supplies and driving to site. Teaching hiking, kayaking, map reading, compass navigation. Educating others about plant and animal life.
- OTHER RESPONSIBILITIES:** CPR, Wilderness First Responder, first aid.
- SKILLS USED:** Speaking, instruction by example, time mgmt., coordinating, athletic ability, people skills.
- TECHNOLOGIES USED:** Climbing equipment, kayaking equipment, hiking gear, compass, maps.
- WHAT DO YOU LOVE ABOUT YOUR JOB:** Working outside, getting exercise. Getting others hooked on nature.
- CHALLENGES OR ANXIETIES:** Weather can cancel classes, participants could get hurt.
- AFTER-WORK ACTIVITIES:** Take dog to park, go out to dinner with friends, read a book. Go to bed at 11 p.m.
- SALARY & BENEFITS:** \$32K to \$62K. Median: \$45K. Medical, dental, vision, life, acupuncture. 401K, discounts, challenge grants.

The Career Compass A DAY IN THE LIFE ... as a(n) _____ for _____

OCCUPATION ORGANIZATION NAME

TIME _____ WAKE UP _____

PRE-WORK ACTIVITIES

Environment

Culture

Coworker & Customer Interaction

EVERYDAY DUTIES:

OTHER RESPONSIBILITIES:

SALARY

BENEFITS

SKILLS USED:

TECHNOLOGIES USED:

WHAT DO YOU LOVE ABOUT YOUR JOB?

CHALLENGES OR ANXIETIES?

AFTER-WORK ACTIVITIES

TIME _____ GO TO BED _____

A completed template might look like this:

The Career Compass A DAY IN THE LIFE ... as a(n) Landscape Designer for Sandpiper Landscape

OCCUPATION ORGANIZATION NAME

TIME 6:10 AM WAKE UP Put on jeans & tee-shirt.

PRE-WORK ACTIVITIES

Environment

Culture

Coworker & Customer Interaction

EVERYDAY DUTIES:

OTHER RESPONSIBILITIES:

SALARY

BENEFITS

SKILLS USED:

TECHNOLOGIES USED:

WHAT DO YOU LOVE ABOUT YOUR JOB?

CHALLENGES OR ANXIETIES?

AFTER-WORK ACTIVITIES

TIME 11:00 PM GO TO BED _____

TIME WAKE UP

● PRE-WORK ACTIVITIES

● Environment

● Culture

JANUARY SMTWTFS
FEBRUARY SMTWTFS
MARCH SMTWTFS
APRIL SMTWTFS
MAY SMTWTFS
JUNE SMTWTFS

TIME WORK DAY BEGINS
● EVERYDAY DUTIES:

● OTHER RESPONSIBILITIES:

TIME BREAK

JULY SMTWTFS
AUGUST SMTWTFS
SEPTEMBER SMTWTFS
OCTOBER SMTWTFS
NOVEMBER SMTWTFS
DECEMBER SMTWTFS

● SKILLS USED:

● TECHNOLOGIES USED:

TIME WORK DAY ENDS

● What do you love about your job?

● What are your challenges or anxieties?

● AFTER-WORK ACTIVITIES

Notes:

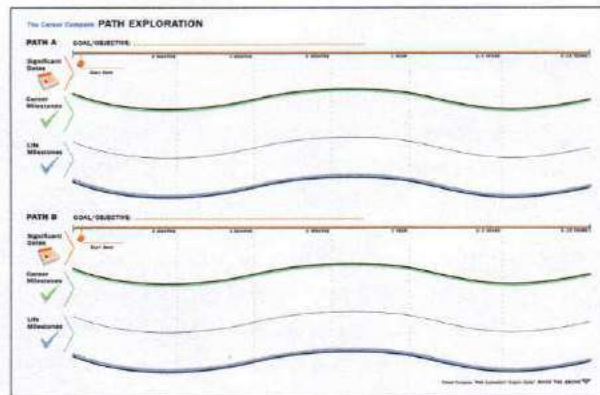
Stage 8

PATH EXPLORATION

So far, you've done self-assessments to get a good understanding of who you are and external research to determine where you want to go and what you want to do. With a clear sense of your goal, you may feel like you are ready to start applying for jobs immediately. However, there is an additional step that may greatly support your future success and happiness.

Path Exploration is a scenario-planning exercise. For this template, we ask you to plot the various career and life milestones that would correspond to a career choice. Seeing the steps on a timeline will help you clarify your future actions. Planning both career and life milestones five to ten years in the future will also help you understand any career/life trade-offs that may affect you.

In addition, and most importantly, *Path Exploration* asks you to plot a second course, or backup plan. While some experience a smooth career path or transition, others may need to regroup. Having a second option can help you greatly if your first choice doesn't work out. A second direction could have a different balance of career and life milestones that turns out to be more attractive in the long run.



*Time flies. It's up to you to be
the navigator.*

Robert Orben

PATH EXPLORATION

Plot Career and Lifestyle Goals

Career decision-making often requires more than one path. You can follow your primary goal—Path A, and achieve your objectives. However, circumstances outside your control may require a detour. Thinking through a different path now may save time and stress later. This template allows you to determine both your primary goals for your career and lifestyle as well as an alternative plan. In addition, this template allows you to compare two different career paths and how they may affect lifestyle choices differently.

STEPS

After completing the *Choices in Context* and *Day in the Life* templates, you should be able to make a decision regarding your preferred career goal. Follow the steps below to map out a future with this career choice (Path A), as well as a second choice (Path B). Take time and think through your options in light of your current life and the life you'd like to have.

PATH A

1. **Goal/Objective:** Use Path A for your first career choice. For example, it might be a new occupation, starting your own business, getting a graduate degree, changing companies or staying with your current company but getting promotions by taking on additional responsibilities. Write down your primary goal or objective on the top of the timeline for Path A.
2. **Significant Dates:** Starting on the left, write down the date (month and year) you are beginning this process. Move to your right and add other significant dates below the timeline. It may be helpful to write down milestone birthdays, such as 18, 21, 30, 40, 50, or 65. You may also want to include the ages of your spouse, partner, parents, and/or children. If your career choice requires education, write down when school applications are due, when the semester begins, or when summer internships may open up. The date of an important job fair would also be significant.
3. **Career Milestones:** Use this horizontal stream to plan the steps you need to take in order to achieve your goal. For example, your goal might be to become a manager at your company. Your initial milestones might be volunteering for a task force. A bit later, you might talk with your boss about your career goals; a year or two later you might take classes or attend workshops; and throughout your career you may be applying for positions within your organization.

If your career choice is something new to you, use the information you have gathered through websites, articles and informational interviews to fill in the milestones. For instance, many career goals will require you to go to school before you're qualified for your new position. In this case, you would need to plot entrance exams, application deadlines, acceptance letters, etc. A degree could take you two to five years; you might need to complete an internship, and then you would have to search for a job after that. Or your plan could be to get experience and progress through several positions to your ultimate goal. Plot each of the milestones leading up to your goal.

In still another case, you may be planning to get a new job within the next several months. Choose a realistic date for getting your new job; then, working backward, fill in the tasks required to get a job offer (see the following *Action Plan* template for help with these details).

If your career goal is of a shorter rather than longer time frame, use the rest of the timeline to write down career milestones that might follow accepting a job such as salary increases, increased responsibility, promotions or relocation.

4. **Life Milestones:** Record significant lifestyle accomplishments you would like to fulfill and that would be doable given the career choice. Finances, health, relationships, environment and leisure are some areas to think about. For some, a life milestone may be financial independence, finding a new place to live, moving to a new city or taking an important trip. Others may want to plot relationship-based milestones, such as marriage or children. Personal-development milestones, such as learning a new language or musical instrument, represent other possibilities. Review your completed *Work/Life Wheel* template and review your priorities. Think about the relationship between the career choice you have made for Path A and your lifestyle goals. There may be some life milestones that may need to be put off. Decide what is most important to you and create a path that has the right balance for you.

PATH B

5. Now that you have a Path A that you are content with, imagine a different direction. Path B is your chance to outline a different future, either slightly or wildly different from Path A. Perhaps there was another profession that interested you while you were doing research, or maybe you know of a job opportunity that a friend or family member has communicated. Or in another scenario, maybe you decide to stay in a current job while you go to night school, pay off some debt and get yourself prepared for the job search at a later date. Maybe your Path A is conservative and with Path B you want to push your career or lifestyle ambitions further. Having a Path B will help you remain flexible in your career planning.

Follow Steps 1 through 4 for Path B.

6. **Final Evaluation:** After you complete Path B, compare both paths. Is Path A still your preference? Which path best matches the priorities you set on your *Work/Life Wheel*? Which path will best fulfill the primary and secondary outcomes that you recorded on the *Setting Out* template? Perhaps upon reflection some of your desired outcomes for career transition have shifted as you've worked through *The Career Compass*.

Choose one path to work toward and one to keep on the back burner. Whichever path you choose, take comfort in knowing that you have options.

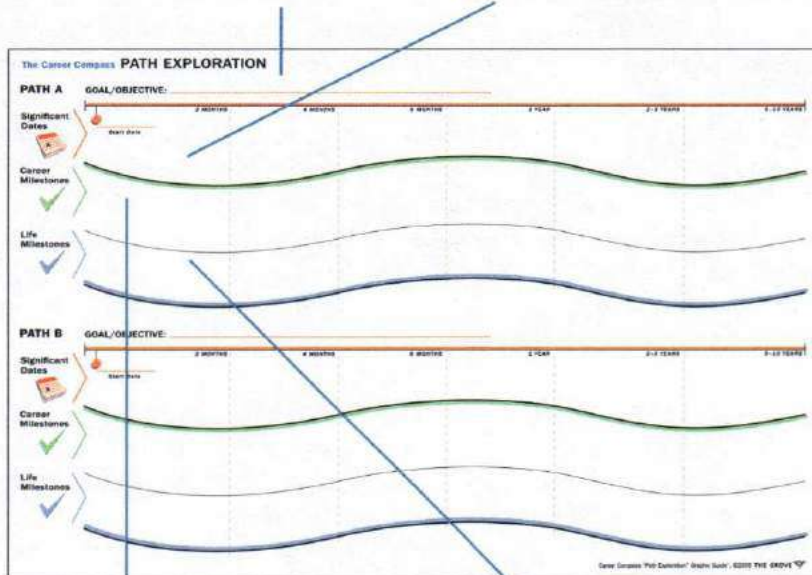
You are now ready to move on to the *Action Plan* template and start searching for that perfect job, internship or educational program. After you land a job, you can use *Path Exploration* to add additional career development and/or lifestyle milestones or revise your initial path.

Use the "Notes" page following the template to capture any additional observations or thoughts.

Sample Answers for Path Exploration:

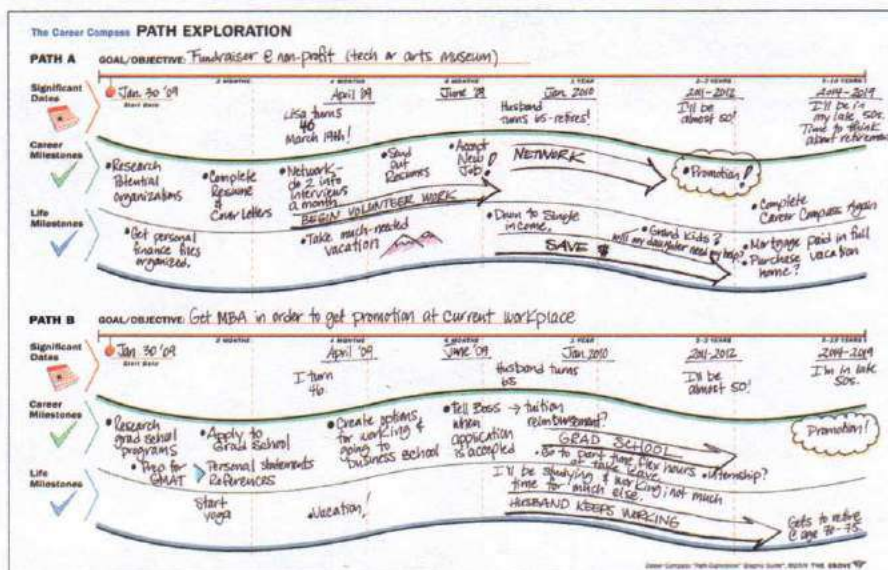
START
HERE

- GOAL/OBJECTIVE:** Public relations representative for environmental organization; get M.B.A.; promotion to VP; become a pediatrician.
- SIGNIFICANT DATES:** Start Date: March, 2009; turn 35; trip to Europe; loan payment due; fall semester begins.



- CAREER MILESTONES:** Complete degree, apply for jobs, land position as customer service representative, move up to supervisor, promotion to store manager. Or, marketing coordinator, marketing manager, VP of marketing and sales. Or, apprentice, journeyman, foreman. Or, associate planner, associate buyer, buyer, divisional manager. Or, research franchise options, get financing, find and lease space, prepare marketing materials, hire staff, open business.
- LIFE MILESTONES:** Move to California, own a home, enroll son in kindergarten, have solo gallery show, join a gym, learn to play the guitar.

A completed template might look like this:



The Career Compass **PATH EXPLORATION**

PATH A

GOAL/OBJECTIVE: _____

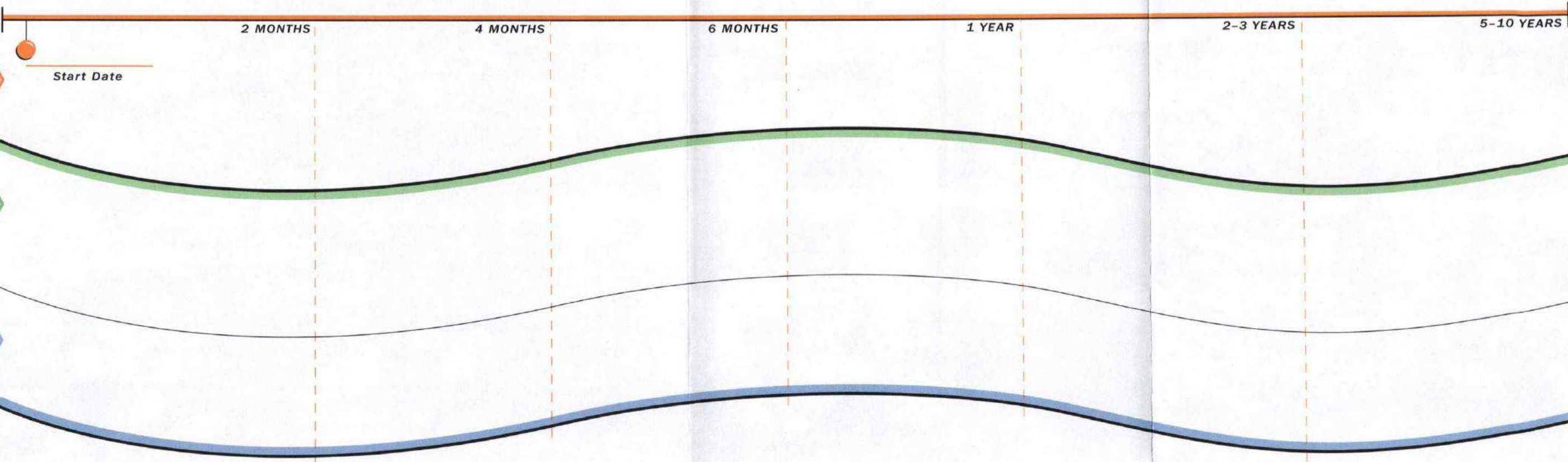
Significant Dates



Career Milestones



Life Milestones



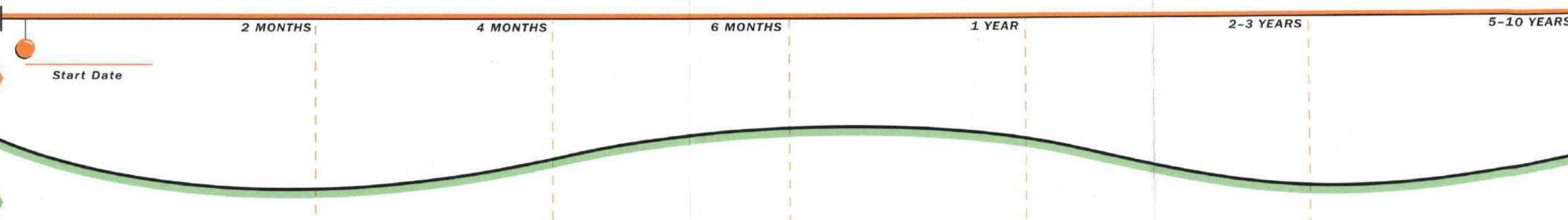
PATH B

GOAL/OBJECTIVE: _____

Significant Dates



Career Milestones



Notes:

Stage 9

ACTION PLAN

In the previous exercise, *Path Exploration*, you determined your first and second choices for career paths. Whether your next career steps involve applying for a job or applying to school, the *Action Plan* template will help you stay organized and take steps toward your future.

Action Plan is designed to keep you accountable to the tasks needed to get job offers or complete a college application process. It helps you set dates and track your progress on a time frame that you determine. In addition, *Action Plan* helps you think about the conditions of your job or education search—the supports you can call on and the challenges you may face. Finally, it keeps you focused on what a job offer must have in order for you to be happy. Good luck!

The Career Compass ACTION PLAN

	TARGET	COLLATERAL MATERIALS	INTERVIEW PREPARATION	INTERVIEWS	OFFERS

CHALLENGES

SUPPORTS

OCCUPATION CHOICE

START JOB BY

*We all must live our lives
always feeling, always thinking
the moment has arrived.*

Tracy Chapman

ACTION PLAN

Set and Accomplish Your Goals

Congratulate yourself for your hard work in self-discovery and research. Now, take that momentum and create a plan for your job search. *The Career Compass Action Plan* is a specific job-hunt calendar that you can use to both plan your steps and keep you on task.

STEPS

By completing *The Career Compass Path Exploration* template, you should have decided on a career direction. Whether one of the first milestones on your path is to get an internship, get work experience or apply for that perfect job, the *Action Plan* helps you organize the tasks involved. You may also be considering undergraduate or graduate school. You can use the *Action Plan* for this purpose as well, keeping in mind that there may be additional tasks involved, depending on the program. Feel free to change the headings on the template to fit your purposes.

1. **Occupation Choice:** Look back at all the maps you have already completed and determine your occupation choice. Be specific, but also keep in mind that different organizations might call the same job by another name. Or, you may choose to select a different position in your current organization. If applying to school, change the heading to "Degree Choice" and write down the degree you will pursue.
2. **Start Job By:** Write down the specific, time-oriented goal for this *Action Plan*. For example: start new job by June 1. If applying to school, you can change the heading to "Start School By" and put in your hoped for start date—fall semester, for example.
3. **Must Have:** Whether or not you are fortunate to have more than one job offer, you need to decide if a job is best for you before you accept. Review your other filled-in *Career Compass* templates to determine what you must have in a job in order to accept—it might be the salary range, opportunity for advancement or the actual work you'll be doing and who you will be doing it with. Sometimes a job sounds wonderful, but if it takes you away from your ultimate long-term goal, you may decide to turn down an offer. If you are applying to school you may consider tuition assistance a "must have" in order to commit to a program.
4. **Nice to Have:** Similar to your "Must Have" list, use this space to write down the aspects of a job that would be nice to have but are not deal breakers. For example, a short commute, the benefits or bonus structure, or extra vacation could be potential items on this list. If an educational program is the focus of your *Action Plan*, you may consider things like university housing or financial aid, as some of your preferences, but not imperatives.
5. **Complete-by Dates:** At the top of each column, write down a goal date for completing the tasks in each column. Later, you'll write down the actual completion dates inside the arrow. Use the "Start Job By" date and work backwards. Keep in mind that in many cases it may take an organization six to eight weeks for their hiring process after an ad has been posted. For example, if your "Start Job By" date is June 1, you may receive offers in the second half of May, your interviews may take place in the first two weeks of May, your interview prep may be completed the last half of April, your collateral materials would be sent by the second week of April, and you would have identified your targets in the first week of April. You may have more time to look for a new job, therefore your "complete-by" dates would reflect a longer time period.
6. **Targets:** The template gives you five organizations or school programs to track. Hopefully, you've gained some leads from your networking efforts. In addition, use Internet job websites to find jobs or internships that are appealing. In addition, a career counselor is a great resource for specialized job-listing information. If you aren't working with a career counselor,

try doing an Internet search by typing in "Careers in _____" You'll often find job-search websites you have never seen before. Also, check national or state professional associations for job boards. Print out job listings, review leads from your *Networking Map*, then prioritize your top five. Write these top-five organizations or schools in the target spaces. If you have more than five, you can put those on another *Action Plan*. (See Appendix.)

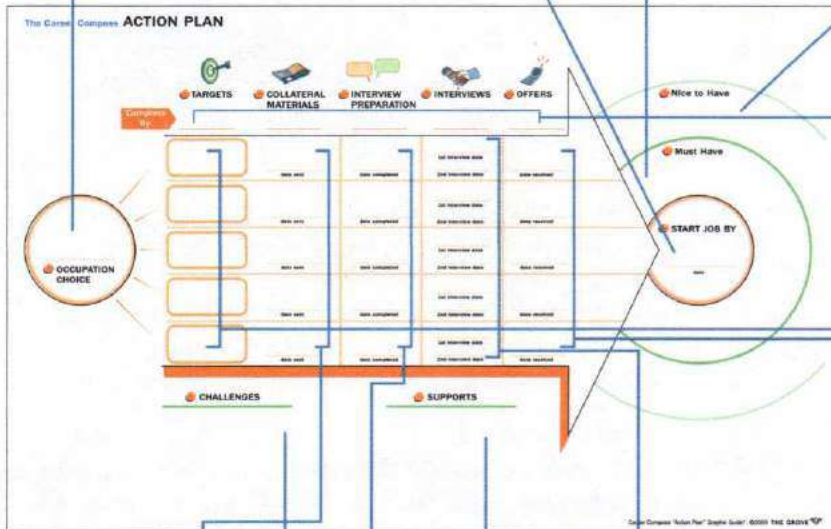
7. **Collateral Materials:** Each target job will have its own set of materials that need to be sent. This can include an application, a resumé, a portfolio, or cover letter for a job. Or, if you are applying for school, you may need an application, transcripts, test scores and a personal statement.
8. **Interview Preparation:** Whether or not you definitely have an interview, you should still prepare ahead of time. Research the organization, the competition, and prepare answers for interview questions. A good place to find information about interviewing is www.jobinterviewquestions.org. Practice your personal statement or "elevator speech" with a friend. Make sure you have appropriate interview clothes. You may even want to travel to the organization to make sure you know where it is and how much time it will take you to get there.
9. **Interviews:** Once the interviews are scheduled, write down the date of your interview. If you are applying and interviewing at multiple companies, this will also allow you to track the dates so that you don't double-book yourself or schedule interviews too closely together. When you arrive at a company, always arrive a bit early and dress for the job you want. Be prepared to ask three to four questions of your own at the end of the interview. These questions should be about performance expectations, reporting structure and professional development rather than salary or benefits. After the interview, be sure to follow up within twenty-four hours with a thank-you note.
10. **Challenges:** Write down the things that may hinder your progress. Consider things that are outside of your control, like a poor economy and things you may be able to control, such as your own personal attitudes or behaviors. Identifying challenges helps prepare you to deal with them when they arise.
11. **Supports:** Identify the people, places and resources that may help you with your *Action Plan*. Write down those people who will support you in your goals. Consider working on your *Networking Map* in conjunction with your *Action Plan*, as your network could certainly support your efforts. Going to a library may help focus your research efforts or allow you access to the Internet if you do not have a computer.
12. **Offers:** If you are lucky, you will have more than one job offer. The offer may come by phone or in writing. If you receive an offer by phone, you may ask to receive the job offer in writing and have at least twenty-four to forty-eight hours to discuss it with your family or friends. Go back to your map and review your Must Have and Nice to Have statements to help you make a decision. If you have questions about the offer, call the hiring manager and discuss them before you accept. If you are expecting more than one offer, use the Date Received line in the arrow to keep track of each offer date. If you need more time to consider an offer, especially if you expect another offer to come, be honest with the employer. You may want to refer to Salary.com's Negotiation Clinic at www.salary.com.

Try not to get discouraged if you have to regroup and create a new *Action Plan*. It is possible that you may not be getting offers for a particular occupation, or may not get into the school program that you wanted. Look back at your *Path Exploration* template. Often a Plan B (Path B) could work out better for you than your Plan A (Path A). See the Appendix if you need an additional *Action Plan*.

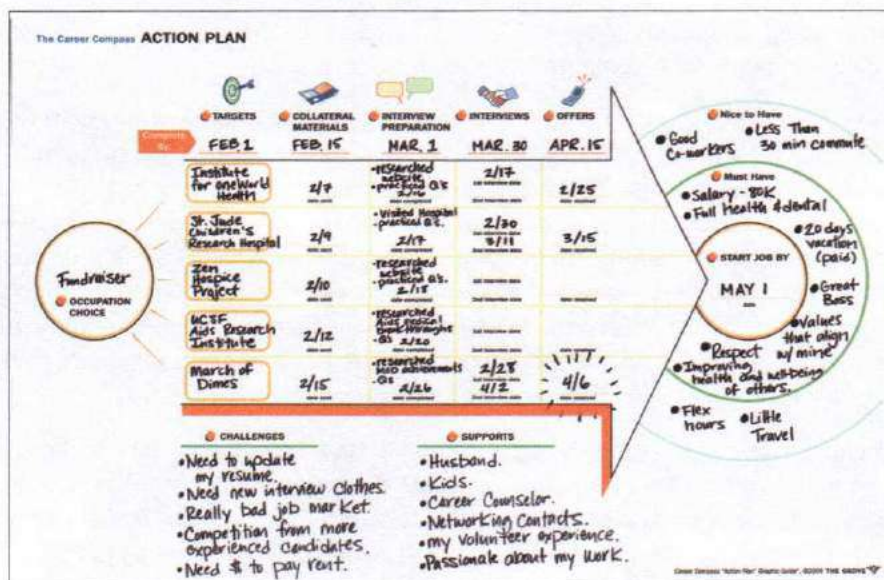
Sample Answers for Action Plan:

START
HERE

- OCCUPATION CHOICE:** Registered nurse; veterinarian; store manager; M.A. in Theater.
- START JOB BY:** April 1.
- MUST HAVE:** Salary of \$50K, health and dental insurance, short commute, good manager, stable business.
- NICE TO HAVE:** Salary more than \$50K, 4 weeks paid vacation; own office, tuition reimbursement.
- COMPLETE-BY DATES:** Select targets by Jan. 1, send collateral by Jan. 20, prepare for interviews Jan. 20–Feb. 1, interviews Jan. 25–Feb. 28, offers Jan. 30–Mar. 15.
- TARGETS:** Physician Foundation at Cal. Pacific Medical Center, Kaiser Permanente, UC San Francisco, Arlington Healthcare, Merritt Hawkins.
- COLLATERAL MATERIALS:** Date you sent your resumé, cover letter, applications, and references.
- INTERVIEW PREPARATION:** Dates you researched company/school and prepared for the interview.
- INTERVIEWS:** Dates of your first and second interview.
- CHALLENGES:** It may take a long time; might not get job offer from first choice; need new interview clothes; transportation; need help with my resume.
- SUPPORTS:** Family, spouse, career counselor, library, career center.
- OFFERS:** Dates you received job offers or acceptance to schools.



A completed template might look like this:



Conclusion

Congratulations. You have just completed a thoughtful and creative process designed to help you change and manage your career. You have looked at your past to find patterns. You've assessed who you are at this point in time and set priorities for your future. You've researched and explored different jobs and careers. Finally, you've determined what's important to you and made informed decisions for the months and years ahead.

As you enter into a new chapter in your career, keep in mind that the world of work is constantly changing. For instance, there are jobs that are made obsolete by new technology. On the flip side, that same technology may create entire new fields. Not only will work change, but at different times in our lives our priorities may shift, as well. One of the most important challenges we all face is to keep up with these changes. To keep yourself current, you should revisit *The Career Compass* process every three to five years.

We wish you success in your career!

Note about *The Personal Compass*

If while you were working through *The Career Compass*, you found yourself wishing you could spend more time working on changing not just your career, but gaining more insight into improving other aspects of your life, we recommend *The Personal Compass*.

While *The Career Compass* focuses primarily on work and its relationship to your life, *The Personal Compass* is a deeper exploration of your overall life purpose. The first in *The Compass* series, this workbook allows you to explore life goals and dreams beyond your career decisions. This process of reflection will help you be more focused and enthusiastic about your life.

You can purchase *The Personal Compass* from our website: www.grove.com.

Appendix

We've included some other items to help you complete *The Career Compass*.

Icon References

At The Grove, we believe in the power of visuals to foster breakthrough thinking. Working with our templates is not about artistic talent, but about capturing information in a big-picture way. If you want to be creative, we have included drawings of some items that may appear on your templates. Redraw these icons on your templates, if you prefer, or come up with your own. Feel free to use different colored pens or photographs to add variety and make distinctions.

Additional Resources

We listed some resources in the *Preferences & Possibilities* section and occasionally for some of the other templates. There are several other valuable books and websites that can help you with career change and development. We have included some of our favorites.

Additional Templates

There are several templates in *The Career Compass* that will require extra space or for you to repeat an exercise multiple times. For this reason, we have included extra copies of the *History*, *Choices in Context*, *A Day in the Life* and *Action Plan* templates.

Icon References



AREA OF STUDY/
REPORT



CLASS/
SEMINAR/TEACHING/
PRESENTING



DIPLOMA



TEST



CHANGE



UPWARD TREND



DOWNWARD TREND



EXCITING/COMPELLING/
KEY EVENT/INSIGHT



BIG DECISION



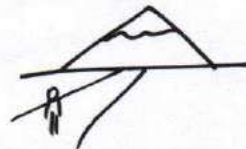
GOAL



ASPIRATION



IDEA



CHALLENGING



INTROVERTED



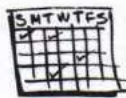
EXTROVERTED



THINKING/
ANALYTICAL



FEELING



JUDGING/
PLANNING



SENSING/
HERE AND NOW



INTUITIVE/
BIG PICTURE



PERCEIVING/
SPONTANEOUS



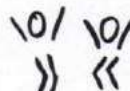
PEOPLE



EXERCISE/LEISURE



EXERCISE/STRENGTH



FUN



STRESS



PERSONAL/
PROFESSIONAL
DEVELOPMENT



GAP



WORK
RELATIONSHIPS



RELATIONSHIPS/
WORKING WITH PEOPLE



TEACHING/PRESENTING



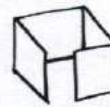
HOUSE



BUILDING



CITY/OFFICES



CUBICLE



TREE/NATURE



CAR/COMMUTE



PUBLIC
TRANSPORTATION



TRAVEL



ARTS/ENTERTAINMENT



ENTERTAINMENT/
ADVERTISING



SCIENCE



HEALTH CARE



MATH



FINANCE



COMPUTER WORK/
SYSTEMS/RESEARCH



LAW/ POLICY



READING/PUBLISHING/
RESEARCHING



WRITING/EDITING



PHYSICAL WORK



PROTECTIVE SERVICES

Additional Resources

BOOKS

Bolles, Richard Nelson. *What Color Is Your Parachute? 2009: A Practical Manual for Job-Hunters and Career-Changers*. 2009 ed. Ten Speed Press, 2008.

Briggs Myers, Isabel. *Gifts Differing: Understanding Personality Type*. Davies-Black Publishing, 1995.

Buckingham, Marcus and Donald Clifton. *Now, Discover Your Strengths*. Free Press, 2001.

Gebhard, Nathan and Mike Marriner and Joanne Gordon. *Roadtrip Nation: A Guide to Discovering Your Path in Life*. Ballantine Books, 2006.

Harvard Business Review Paperback Series. *Harvard Business Review on Work and Life Balance*. Harvard Business School Press, 2000.

Ireland, Susan. *The Complete Idiot's Guide to the Perfect Resume*. 4th ed. Alpha, 2006.

Keirsey, David and Marilyn Bates. *Please Understand Me: Character & Temperament Types*. 5th ed. Prometheus Nemesis Book Company, 1984.

Krumboltz, John and Al Levin. *Luck Is No Accident: Making the Most of Happenstance in Your Life and Career*. Impact Publishers, 2004.

Rath, Tom. *StrengthsFinder 2.0: A New and Upgraded Edition of the Online Test from Gallup's Now, Discover Your Strengths*. Gallup Press, 2007.

Sher, Barbara. *I Could Do Anything If I Only Knew What It Was: How to Discover What You Really Want and How to Get It*. Dell, 1995.

Tieger, Paul D. and Barbara Barron. *Do What You Are: Discover the Perfect Career for You Through the Secrets of Personality Type*. 4th ed. Little, Brown & Co., 2007.

Yate, Martin. *Knock 'em Dead 2009: The Ultimate Job Search Guide*. Adams Media, 2008.

Yate, Martin. *Knock 'em Dead Resumes: Features the Latest Information on: Online Postings, Email Techniques, and Follow-up Strategies*. 8th ed. Adams Media, 2008.

WEBSITES*

Authentic Happiness, hosted by Dr. Martin Seligman at University of Pennsylvania:
<http://www.authentic happiness.sas.upenn.edu/Default.aspx>

Career Interests Game: <http://career.missouri.edu/students/explore/thecareerinterestsgame.php>

Hoover's, Inc: <http://www.hoovers.com/>

Job Hunter's Bible—Richard Bolles: <http://www.jobhuntersbible.com/>

Job Interview Questions: <http://www.jobinterviewquestions.org/>

National Career Development Association: <http://www.ncda.org/>

Occupational Information Network—O*NET OnLine: <http://online.onetcenter.org/>

Quintessential Careers: <http://www.quintcareers.com/>

Salary.com: <http://www.salary.com/>

Selfcounseling.com: <http://www.selfcounseling.com/help/personalsuccess/personalvalues.html>

Self-Directed Search by Dr. John Holland: <http://www.self-directed-search.com/>

StrengthsQuest™: <https://www.strengthsquest.com>

The Keirsey Temperament Sorter® II: <http://keirsey.com/>

Wetfeet: <http://www.wetfeet.com/>

Wall Street Journal Careers: <http://online.wsj.com/public/page/news-career-jobs.html>

* The website sources listed were available at the time of publication. We apologize if websites have changed.

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